

FAB4 Does Europe - September 2026

10 - 29 September 2026



Flight Summary

Date	Flight	Terminal	Airline	Route	Depart → Arrive	Cabin	Duration
Thu 10 Sept	QF162	T1 → T1	Qantas	Wellington (WLG) → Sydney (SYD)	6:05am → 7:45am	Business	3h 40m
Thu 10 Sept	QF1	T1 → T1	Qantas	Sydney (SYD) → Singapore (SIN)	2:45pm → 9:15pm	Premium Economy	8h 30m
Thu 10 - Fri 11 Sept	BA12	T1 → T5	British Airways	Singapore (SIN) → London Heathrow (LHR)	11:20/11:25pm → 6:35am +1	Premium Economy	~14h 10-15m
Fri 11 Sept	BA548	T5 → T3	British Airways	London Heathrow (LHR) → Rome Fiumicino (FCO)	8:00am → 11:35am	Business	2h 35m
Fri 11 Sept	BA548	T5 → T3	British Airways	London Heathrow (LHR) → Rome Fiumicino (FCO)	8:00am → 11:35am	Economy	2h 35m
Thu 24 Sept	BA575	n/a → T5	British Airways	Milan Linate (LIN) → London Heathrow (LHR)	3:55pm → 4:50pm	Business	1h 55m
Sun 27 - Mon 28 Sept	BA15	T5 → T1	British Airways	London Heathrow (LHR) → Singapore (SIN)	10:00pm → 6:40pm +1	Premium Economy	13h 40m
Mon 28 - Tue 29 Sept	BA15	T1 → T1	British Airways	Singapore (SIN) → Sydney (SYD)	8:20pm → 6:05am +1	Premium Economy	7h 45m
Tue 29 Sept	QF161	T1 → n/a	Qantas	Sydney (SYD) → Wellington (WLG)	9:35am → 3:45pm	Economy	3h 10m

☐ Karen & Gary only
 ☐ Deb & Tom only
 ☐ All 4 together

All flights are on 2026 dates, operated by Qantas (QF) and British Airways (BA). Reservation codes: Gary & Karen - KXFECY / EKNMYW; Deb & Tom - UWBGQP / EKH3PP (the Akhursts join the group in Sydney, so have no Wellington-Sydney sector). Frequent flyer numbers, seat assignments and check-in requirements are held in the original Sabre itinerary emails.

Sydney layover (Thu 10 Sept, ~7 hrs): Yes, you can leave the airport. As NZ passport holders, Gary & Karen are automatically granted a Special Category (subclass 444) visa on arrival, so there's no separate visa to arrange. A ~7 hour layover is comfortably above the ~5 hour minimum generally recommended to clear immigration, get into the city and back through security in time (allow ~45 min for immigration on arrival, ~60 min for security before the next departure).

Singapore transit on BA15 (Mon 28 Sept, ~1h 40m): Everyone must deplane at Changi with all carry-on items - there's no option to stay onboard. On one ticket with bags checked through you won't need to clear passport control, but you WILL need to re-clear security before boarding the onward

Sydney sector, as security is at the gate in Singapore. Queues can be long since the whole aircraft transits at once – follow the crew's instruction on what time to be back at the gate.

Trip at a Glance

Thu 10 Sep (Day 1)	Air travel CONFIRMED Gary & Karen: QF162 (Qantas) Wgtn (WLG) to Syd (T1), arrive 7.45am - FAB4: QF1 (Qantas) Syd (T1) to Singapore (T1), depart 2.45pm, PE SIN transit ~2hrs (T1) - BA12 SIN (T1) to LHR (T5) arrive 6.35am, then BA548 LHR (T5) to FCO (T3) depart 8.00am (both British Airways) - Business Gary & Karen / Economy Deb & Tom	✈
Fri 11 Sep (Day 2)	Arrival in Rome	☐☐
Sat 12 Sep (Day 3)	Rome CONFIRMED Pristine Sistine Early Morning Small Group Tour	☐☐
Sun 13 Sep (Day 4)	Rome CONFIRMED Colosseum Areana Floor & VIP Caesar's Palace	☐☐
Mon 14 Sep (Day 5)	Rome UNCONFIRMED Transfer by Private Minibus to Queen Victoria	☐☐
Tue 15 Sep (Day 6)	Sea Day	☐☐
Wed 16 Sep (Day 7)	Marseille France CONFIRMED Marseille and the little train (booked)	☐☐
Thu 17 Sep (Day 8)	Villefranche, France CONFIRMED Monaco Old Town & Scenic Drive (booked)	☐☐
Fri 18 Sep (Day 9)	Genoa, Italy CONFIRMED Discover Genoa (booked)	☐☐
Sat 19 Sep (Day 10)	La Spezia (Florence or Pisa) CONFIRMED Easy Pisa (booked)	☐☐
Sun 20 Sep (Day 11)	Sea Day	☐☐
Mon 21 Sep (Day 12)	Tuscany	☐☐
Tue 22 Sep (Day 13)	Tuscany	☐☐
Wed 23 Sep (Day 14)	Milan	☐☐
Thu 24 Sep (Day 15)	London CONFIRMED Dinner at The Lighterman confirmed (4NJL3Z4M6XN3) BA575 (British Airways) Milan Linate to London Heathrow (T5), Depart 3.55pm arrive 4.50pm, Business, all 4	☐☐
Fri 25 Sep (Day 16)	London CONFIRMED The Mousetrap (confirmed), Dinner at Albert Schloss confirmed	☐☐
Sat 26 Sep (Day 17)	London UNCONFIRMED Tower / Bridge Tour then Six show and then dinner	☐☐
Sun 27 Sep (Day 18)	Air Travel - Depart LHR (T5) 10.00pm CONFIRMED BA15 (British Airways) London Heathrow (T5) to Singapore (SIN T1), Premium Economy, all 4 NZ Daylight Saving starts here	✈
Mon 28 Sep (Day 19)	Air Travel - Arrive SIN (T1) 6.40pm - Depart 8.20pm CONFIRMED BA15 (British Airways) Singapore (SIN T1) to Sydney (SYD T1), Premium Economy, all 4	✈
Tue 29 Sep (Day 20)	HOME CONFIRMED FAB4 Arrive SYD (T1) 6.05am (Karen and Gary depart SYD (T1) 9.35am on QF161 (Qantas), Economy, arrive WGTN 3.45pm	✈

Rome

11 – 14 September · The Republic Hotel, Via Gaeta 61

'I' buttons link to that place's official Instagram page.

-
- 11:30 AM** **Arrive Fiumicino Airport (FCO Terminal 3) 11.35am - flight BA548 (British Airways) from London Heathrow (T5)**
-
- 12:00 PM** **Transfer by private minibus - airport to The Republic Hotel (~30-45 min drive depending on traffic, ~28 min best case)**
Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome
[///sports.pocket.anchors](https://sports.pocket.anchors)
-
- 12:30 PM** **Check in at The Republic Hotel, freshen up**
[///sports.pocket.anchors](https://sports.pocket.anchors)
-
- 1:00 PM** **Piazza della Repubblica & Fontana delle Naiadi**
Piazza della Repubblica, Rome - ~5 min walk from hotel
[///mouth.dished.cheaply](https://mouth.dished.cheaply)
-
- 1:30 PM** **Santa Maria degli Angeli e dei Martiri (built into the ancient Baths of Diocletian, free entry)**
Piazza della Repubblica, Rome - ~5 min walk from hotel
[///mouth.dished.cheaply](https://mouth.dished.cheaply)
-
- 2:00 PM** **Free time / coffee near the hotel**
-
- 2:30 PM** **Travel to Villa Borghese Gardens (~20 min by taxi or metro)**
-
- 3:00 PM - 5pm** **Villa Borghese Gardens**
Villa Borghese, Rome, Italy
-
- 5:00 PM - 6:15pm** **Pre-dinner drinks - Terrazza Montemartini (rooftop bar, Palazzo Montemartini) Visit Website: Palazzo Montemartini**
Largo Giovanni Montemartini, Rome - ~10 min walk from hotel
[Website](#)
-
- 6:30 PM** **Dinner - pick from the suggestions below**
-

Dinner Suggestions (8 ideas, within ~20 min walk of the hotel)

Trimani Il Winebar

Rome's original wine bar (est. 1821 as a wine merchant) - simple Roman menu, huge wine list, fair prices

Via Cernaia 37 - ~3 min walk

☐ **Mon-Sat 11:30am-3pm & 5:30pm-midnight (closed Sun)**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

☐ *Trimani started life in 1821 as a family wine merchant business - it's still run by the same Trimani family six generations later, and was the first place in the world to actually call itself a "Wine Bar".*

Rifugio Romano

Cosy trattoria a couple of minutes from Termini - classic Roman pastas, friendly service

Via Volturno 12 - ~6 min walk

☐ **Tue-Sun 12:30pm-11pm (closed Mon)**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Osteria Quarantaquattro

Relaxed osteria near Piazza della Repubblica - Roman staples, good value set menus

Via Volturno area - ~6 min walk

☐ **Check ahead - hours not consistently published**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Pizzeria Ristoro Est! Est!! Est!!!

Rome's oldest pizzeria (since 1905) - thin-crust Roman-style pizza, great old-school atmosphere

Via Genova 32 - ~8 min walk

☐ **Check ahead - typically lunch & dinner daily**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

☐ *The odd name comes from a medieval legend: a bishop travelling to Rome sent his servant ahead to chalk "Est!" (Latin for "it is [good]") on the doors of inns with good wine. At Montefiascone the wine was so good the servant wrote "Est! Est!! Est!!!" three times - the bishop loved it so much he settled there for the rest of his life.*

Osteria Barberini

Cosy osteria near Piazza Barberini - known for truffle dishes and classic Roman cuisine

Via della Purificazione 21 - ~17 min walk

☐ **Mon-Sat 12:30-2:30pm & 7-11pm (closed Sun)**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Trattoria dell'Omo

Probably the closest proper trattoria to Termini - traditional Roman menu that changes by the day (gnocchi on Thursdays)

Via Vicenza 18 - ~5 min walk

☐ **Daily 12pm-3pm & 7pm-10:45pm**

[Reviews](#)

La Matriciana dal 1870

Rome institution since 1870 opposite the Opera House - the amatriciana it's named after, plus classic carbonara

Via del Viminale 44 - ~10 min walk

☐ **Sun-Fri 12:15-3pm & 7:15-11pm (closed Sat)**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Trattoria Monti

Long-running family trattoria near Piazza Vittorio serving Le Marche regional dishes - olive ascolane, tortello al rosso d'uovo. Book ahead, it's popular

Via di San Vito 13 - ~12 min walk

☐ **Check ahead - reservations recommended**

[Reviews](#)

☐ **Staying at The Republic Hotel, Rome - Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome (+39 06 8115 7001 - therepublic@aghotels.it)**

5:30 AM

Early breakfast at The Republic Hotel (confirm 5:30am service with hotel in advance - standard buffet runs 7:00-10:30am) [TO CONFIRM](#)

The Republic Hotel, Via Gaeta 61, Rome

[///sports.pocket.anchors](#)

7:00 AM -
11:15am

Pristine Sistine Early Morning Small Group Tour - entry 7:15am (4hrs)

Vatican Museums / Sistine Chapel, Vatican City Visit Website: Walks of Italy

[Website](#) [I](#)

12:00 PM

Lunch at Target Restaurant [OPTIONAL](#)

Near Piazza della Repubblica, Rome - ~8 min walk from hotel Visit Website: Ristorante Target

[Website](#)

1:00 PM

Free afternoon in Rome - pick from the 6 suggestions below

Saturday Afternoon Suggestions (6 ideas, after lunch)

Trevi Fountain [///wiped.school.dreaming](#)

Iconic baroque fountain - toss a coin in for luck (~15 min walk from hotel)

Piazza di Trevi, Rome

Spanish Steps & Piazza di Spagna [///rungs.diverts.tractor](#)

Famous steps, great people-watching and shopping nearby (~20 min walk)

Piazza di Spagna, Rome

Pantheon [///strictly.into.evokes](#)

Best-preserved ancient Roman building, free entry (~20-25 min walk)

Piazza della Rotonda, Rome

Piazza Navona [///drank.navy.scanning](#)

Grand baroque square with Bernini's Fountain of the Four Rivers, lively cafes (~25-30 min walk or short taxi)

Piazza Navona, Rome

Galleria Borghese

///detained.planting.describe

World-class Bernini/Caravaggio art collection - needs a pre-booked timed entry ticket, so only if booked in advance

Piazzale Scipione Borghese 5, Rome

Website

Vatican Necropolis (Scavi Tour) - Tomb of St Peter

///searched.circling.supposed

Guided tour through the ancient necropolis beneath St Peter's Basilica, ending at the tomb believed to hold St Peter's remains - must be booked well in advance, no photos allowed, small groups only

Meet at the Ufficio Scavi (Excavations Office), Piazza San Pietro, Vatican City

Website

Reviews

8 More Dinner Suggestions (no repeats from the 11th)

Ai Tre Scalini - Bottiglieria dal 1895

Historic Monti wine bar (since 1895) - great wines by the glass, traditional small plates, lively atmosphere

Via Panisperna 251, Monti - ~15 min walk

☐ Daily 12pm-10pm

Reviews

☐ The name means "at the three steps" - a nod to the three little steps down into its cosy, cellar-like wine bar, which has barely changed since it opened in 1895.

La Carbonara

Rome institution since 1906, famous for its namesake dish - carbonara, amatriciana, cacio e pepe

Via Panisperna 214, Monti - ~15 min walk

☐ Mon-Sat 12:30-2:30pm & 7-11pm (closed Sun)

Reviews

☐ Ironically, this restaurant opened in 1906 - decades before food historians think the dish carbonara was even invented (most trace it to Rome in the 1940s, possibly influenced by American GI rations of eggs and bacon).

Al Vino al Vino

Intimate Monti enoteca (since 1999) - excellent wine list by the glass, sweet-and-sour eggplant caponata

Via dei Serpenti 19, Monti - ~14 min walk

☐ **Mon-Thu & Sun 7pm-midnight, Fri-Sat 7pm-1:30am**

Reviews

La Taverna dei Monti

Popular traditional trattoria - carbonara, cacio e pepe and other Roman staples done well

Via del Boschetto 41, Monti - ~15 min walk

☐ **Tue-Sun 12:30pm-11pm (closed Mon)**

Reviews

Alle Carrette

One of the best-loved pizzerias in Monti - good prices, lovely courtyard seating out back

Vicolo delle Carrette, Monti - ~16 min walk

☐ **Check ahead - published hours conflict between sources**

Reviews

Maharajah

Well-rated Indian restaurant in the middle of Monti - good change of pace if craving something other than Italian

Via dei Serpenti 124, Monti - ~14 min walk

☐ **Mon-Thu 12:30-3pm & 7:30pm-midnight (check ahead for weekends)**

Website

Reviews

Temakinho

Fun Brazilian-Japanese fusion (sushi meets caipirinha) - colourful spot a few steps from the Colosseum end of Monti

Via dei Serpenti 16, Monti - ~13 min walk

☐ **Daily 12-3:30pm & 7-11:30pm**

[Website](#)[Reviews](#)

Taverna Romana

Popular family-run local spot known for authentic Roman cuisine and reasonable prices - book ahead as it fills fast

Via della Madonna dei Monti 79, Monti - ~14 min walk

🕒 **Mon-Sat 12-3pm & 7:30-11pm (closed Sun)**

[Reviews](#)

📍 **Staying at The Republic Hotel, Rome - Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome (+39 06 8115 7001 · therepublic@aghotels.it)**

- 8:00 AM**

Breakfast at The Republic Hotel (included, buffet 7:00-10:30am)

The Republic Hotel, Via Gaeta 61, Rome

[///sports.pocket.anchors](https://sports.pocket.anchors)
- 9:00 AM**

Self-guided morning walk - Roman Forum viewpoint, Trajan's Column & Markets, Piazza del Campidoglio (all free, ~10 min walk to Piazza del Colosseo afterwards)

Via dei Fori Imperiali, Rome
- 1:00 PM**

Lunch near Piazza del Colosseo - pick from the 5 suggestions below
- 3:30 PM - 7:00pm**

Colosseum Arena Floor & VIP Caesar's Palace Tour - meet 3:30pm (3.5hrs)

Piazza del Colosseo, 1, 00184 Roma RM, Italy Visit Website: Walks of Italy

[///food.reddish.dormant](https://food.reddish.dormant)

[Website](#) [I](#)

Lunch Suggestions Near Piazza del Colosseo (8 ideas, before the tour)

Il Salotto del Colosseo

TripAdvisor 4.7★ - "great lunch by the Colosseum", cosy hidden gem

Via di S. Giovanni in Laterano 42, Rome - ~2 min from Piazza del Colosseo

☐ **Daily 11am-11:30pm**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Fuorinorma

TripAdvisor 4.8★ - "best panini in Rome", fresh charcuterie boards, quick and casual

Via dei Serpenti 178, Monti - ~10 min walk to Colosseo

☐ **Mon-Sat 11:30am-11:30pm (closed Sun)**

[Reviews](#)

Trattoria Luzzi

Bustling local trattoria/pizzeria, a few blocks from the Colosseum - good value, always busy

Via di San Giovanni in Laterano 88, Rome

☐ **Mon, Tue, Thu-Sun 12pm-midnight (closed Wed)**

Coming Out

TripAdvisor 4.6★ - relaxed all-day cafe/bar right by the Colosseum, big varied menu

Via San Giovanni in Laterano 8, Rome

☐ **Check ahead - known for long/late hours but not consistently published**

Le Naumachie (Naumachia)

Long-running Roman/Tuscan institution near the Colosseum, grilled mains

Via Celimontana 7, Rome

☐ **Daily 11am-11:30pm**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Cafè Cafè

Relaxed bistro/wine bar near the Colosseum - smoothies, salads and sandwiches, good for a lighter lunch

Via dei Santi Quattro 44, Rome

☐ **Mon & Wed-Sun 9:30am-7:45pm, Tue 9:30am-4:15pm**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Terre e Domus

Enoteca run by the Province of Rome next to Trajan's Column - ingredients sourced entirely from the Lazio region

Foro Traiano 82, Rome

☐ **Daily 9am-midnight**

[Reviews](#)

La Taverna dei Quaranta

Family-run local trattoria near the Colosseum, serving since 1984 - authentic Roman classics

Via Claudia 24, Rome

☐ **Mon-Wed 12-3:30pm & 7:30pm-midnight**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

8 More Dinner Suggestions (no repeats - handy for after the Colosseum tour)

Hostaria al Boschetto

Warm, cosy Roman comfort food - a Monti favourite, fair prices

Via del Boschetto, Monti - ~15 min walk

☐ **Check ahead - hours not consistently published**

[Reviews](#)

Urbana 47

Farm-to-table Italian - seasonal, organic produce with a modern twist on Roman classics

Via Urbana 47, Monti - ~15 min walk

☐ **Daily 8:30am-midnight**

[Website](#)

La Bottega del Caffè

Lively bar/trattoria right on the prettiest square in Monti - good for a relaxed evening

Piazza Madonna dei Monti 5, Monti - ~16 min walk

☐ **Mon-Sat 8am-2am, Sun 9am-2am**

[Reviews](#)

Ornelli Black Angus Steakhouse

TripAdvisor 4.8★ - top-rated steakhouse, handy since it's right near where today's Colosseum tour finishes

Via Merulana 224 - ~20 min walk from hotel, ~5 min from the Colosseum

☐ **Closed Mondays - check ahead for exact times**

[Reviews](#)

Cuoco & Camicia

TripAdvisor 4.5★ - relaxed elegance, modern Italian cuisine, near the Colosseum end of the tour

Near Cavour/Colosseum - ~22 min walk from hotel, ~5 min from the Colosseum

☐ **Check ahead - hours not consistently published**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Trattoria Vecchia Roma

Traveller's Choice 2025 winner, est. 1916 - famous for its Amatriciana Flambé, near Piazza Vittorio

Via Ferruccio 12B/C, Esquilino - ~18 min walk

☐ **Mon-Sat 12:30-3pm & 7-11pm (closed Sun)**

[Reviews](#)

Le Caveau

Traveller's Choice-rated Italian restaurant near Piazza Vittorio - fried baby octopus, burrata, good all-rounder

Via Conte Verde 6, Esquilino - ~15 min walk

☐ **Daily 12pm-11pm**

[Reviews](#)

Hostaria Al Gladiatore

Over 200 years serving Roman classics right on Piazza del Colosseo - come for the Colosseum view as much as the carbonara

Piazza del Colosseo 5 - ~20 min walk from hotel, on the Colosseum square

☐ **Daily 7am-midnight**

[Reviews](#)

☐ **Staying at The Republic Hotel, Rome - Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome (+39 06 8115 7001 - therepublic@aghotels.it)**

Things to Consider - Rome / Cruise

Day	Item	Status	Notes
Tuscany	Coffee/breakfast stop - Il Caffè degli Amici	OPTIONAL	Tripadvisor 4.7/5 (562 reviews). Via Roma 121, ~5 min walk from Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais. See Italy Map tab.
Tuscany	Pastries/coffee stop - Pasticceria La Golosa	OPTIONAL	Tripadvisor 4.4/5 (31 reviews). Via Palazzuolo, ~7 min walk from Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais. See Italy Map tab.

Sat (12)	Plan Saturday afternoon in Rome TO DO	TO CONFIRM	Free from ~11:15am after the Sistine Chapel tour
Sun (13)	Plan Sunday morning in Rome TO DO	TO CONFIRM	Free until the 3:30pm Colosseum tour
Mon (14)	Confirm transfer time to Queen Victoria TO DO	TO CONFIRM	Likely mid-afternoon - what to do in Rome first thing that morning?
Wed (16)	Land excursion - Marseille, France	BOOKED	Queen Victoria shore day
Thu (17)	Land excursion - Villefranche, France	BOOKED	Queen Victoria shore day
Fri (18)	Land excursion - Genoa, Italy	BOOKED	Queen Victoria shore day
Sat (19)	Land excursion - La Spezia (Florence or Pisa)	BOOKED	Queen Victoria shore day
Rome	Choose restaurant for Veal Scaloppine al limone dinner TO DO	TO CONFIRM	Options on Rome Map tab: Cantina Cantarini da Mario, Girarrosto Fiorentino, Colline Emiliane, Trattoria Monti
Tuscany	Dinner option - Ristorante Triocco	OPTIONAL	Tripadvisor 4.6/5 (334 reviews), #2 of 20 in Barberino Val d'Elsa. Via Vittorio Veneto 48, ~5 km / short drive from hotel (in Barberino Val d'Elsa, not walking distance). See Tuscany Map tab.
Tuscany	Lunch option (en route, 21 Sep) - Agriturismo Buratta, Talamone	OPTIONAL	Tripadvisor 4.0/5 (832 reviews), #1 of 19 restaurants in Talamone. Strada Vicinale delle Casacce 65, Talamone - stop along the Civitavecchia to Tuscany drive route. See Tuscany Map tab.

Queen Victoria Cruise

14 – 21 September (7 nights, round trip from Civitavecchia) · Marseille · Villefranche · Genoa · La Spezia

'I' buttons link to that place's official Instagram page.

□ Gala Evenings – V618D (confirmed from Voyage Info, booking 3Q8W5T)

Tue 15 Sep (sea day) – **Red and Gold**

Sat 19 Sep (La Spezia/Pisa day) – **Roaring 20s**

Every other night on board is smart attire. Both gala nights are picked out in **bold red** in the itinerary table below so they can't be missed.

□ Onboard Costs & Local Taxes

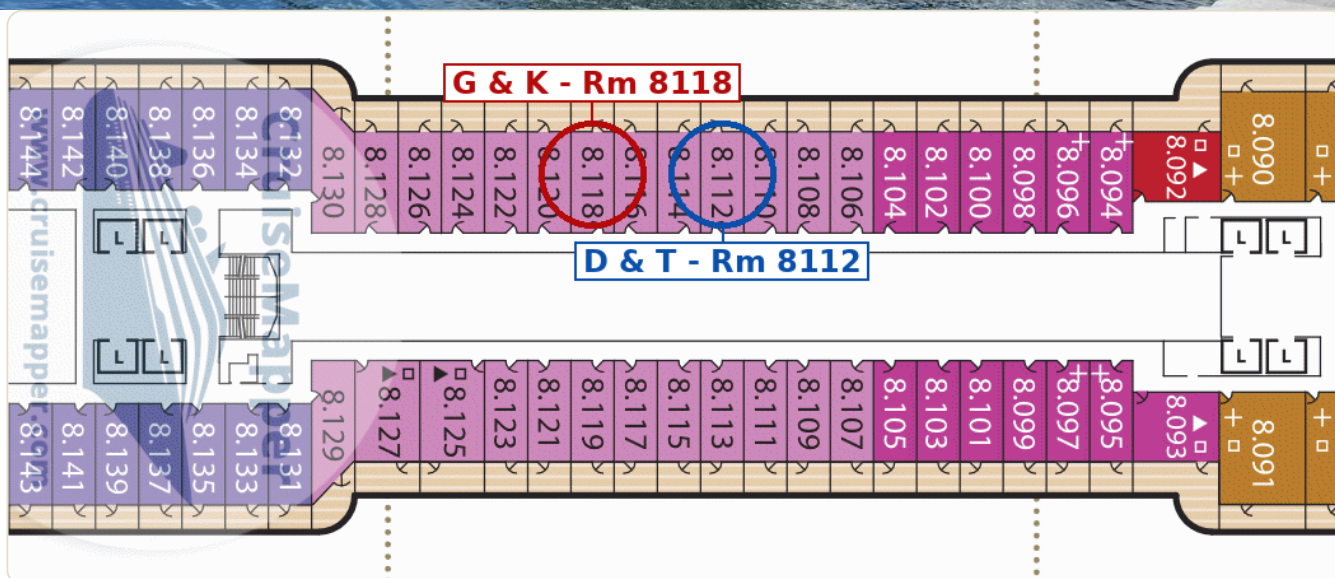
Your AU-market fare already includes port taxes and government fees – **no port on this itinerary charges a landing tax at the gangway**. Italian and French tourist taxes only apply if you sleep ashore, which you don't on any of these port days.

- **Onboard hotel/service charge:** US\$18 per person, per day – roughly **US\$252 for the two of you** across the 7-night voyage, billed to your onboard account in USD.
- **Drinks:** 18% gratuity added automatically to every bar/drinks charge on board.
- **Ashore:** entry tickets, transport and any ATM/FX conversion costs are on you – including the new €2 Trevi Fountain entry ticket if you're revisiting Rome-area sights.
- **Booking conditions clause 36** lets Cunard pass on any tourist/landing taxes introduced after booking, and change the service charge rate before you sail.

Two things worth acting on: EES biometrics have been live at EU borders since April 2026, so allow extra time at Civitavecchia on embarkation day; and My Cunard onboard tour prices close about 4 days before sailing (~10 Sep) at roughly 10% below the on-board price, so book any extra shore tours before then.

☐ Booked Tours & Port Notes

- **Wed 16 Sep - Marseille:** Little Train tour booked.
- **Thu 17 Sep - Villefranche/Monaco:** Monaco Old Town tour booked. Villefranche is a **tender port** - the ship anchors offshore and you'll be ferried in by tender boat, so allow extra time to get ashore.
- **Fri 18 Sep - Genoa:** Discover Genoa tour booked.
- **Sat 19 Sep - La Spezia:** Easy Pisa tour booked, departs 7:45am.



Deck 8 (Balcony) - our two staterooms circled

□ Our Staterooms - Queen Victoria (Deck 8, Balcony)

8118 Gary & Karen

8112 Deb & Tom

See the Deck 8 plan above for exact locations.

2:00 PM **Transfer by private minibus to Queen Victoria - evening departure** TO CONFIRM

Civitavecchia Downtown, Via 16 Settembre 46, Cruise Ship Gate

[///snipe.nipped.miss](http://snipe.nipped.miss)**6:00 PM** **Board Queen Victoria - depart Rome (Civitavecchia)**

Civitavecchia Downtown, Via 16 Settembre 46, Cruise Ship Gate

7:00 PM **Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)**BOOKED

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Website**8:00 PM** **Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre** OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM **Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club**OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

 **Staying aboard Queen Victoria (departs Rome)** **Tonight is a Gala Evening - Red and Gold**

Formal dress code on board tonight (a sea day, so plenty of time to get ready). See the Gala Evenings box in the Queen Victoria Cruise overview above for the full confirmed schedule.

9:00 AM

Sea Day

Aboard Queen Victoria

4:00 PM

Drinking Gin

Aboard Queen Victoria

5:00 PM

Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

6:00 PM

Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)

BOOKED

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Website



8:00 PM

Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM

Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club - Gary's Rhubarb Gin review: smooth, floral, dangerously easy to drink (9/10) OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria



Staying aboard Queen Victoria

8:00 AM In port: Marseille, France

Marseille, France

9:00 AM Marseille and the Little Train

BOOKED

Visit Website: Cunard Shore Excursions

Website



5:00 PM Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

6:00 PM Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)

BOOKED

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Website



8:00 PM Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club - Gary's Pepsi Max review: does exactly what a Pepsi Max should do, zero surprises (7/10)

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria



📌 **Staying aboard Queen Victoria**

8:00 AM In port: Villefranche, France

Villefranche, France

9:00 AM Monaco and the Old Town **BOOKED**

Visit Website: Cunard Shore Excursions

[Website](#) **I**

5:00 PM Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub **OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

6:00 PM Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)

BOOKED

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

[Website](#) **I**

8:00 PM Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre **OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

I

☐ Staying aboard Queen Victoria

8:00 AM

In port: Genoa, Italy

Genoa, Italy

9:00 AM

Discover Genoa shore excursion

BOOKED

Visit Website: Cunard Shore Excursions

Website



5:00 PM

Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

6:00 PM

Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)

BOOKED

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Website



8:00 PM

Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM

Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria



10:00 PM

Churchill's Cigar Lounge, Level 10

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria, Level 10 (Commodore Deck)

☐ **Staying aboard Queen Victoria**

☐ **Tonight is a Gala Evening - Roaring 20s**

Formal dress code on board tonight after today's La Spezia/Pisa excursion. See the Gala Evenings box in the Queen Victoria Cruise overview above for the full confirmed schedule.

8:00 AM In port: La Spezia (Florence or Pisa)

La Spezia, Italy

9:00 AM Easy Pisa - 7.45am tour BOOKED

Visit Website: Cunard Shore Excursions

[Website](#) I

5:00 PM Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

6:00 PM Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)

BOOKED

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

[Website](#) I

8:00 PM Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

I

I **Staying aboard Queen Victoria**

9:00 AM

Sea Day

Aboard Queen Victoria

4:00 PM

Drinking Gin

Aboard Queen Victoria

5:00 PM

Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

6:00 PM

Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)

BOOKED

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Website



8:00 PM

Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM

Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria



📌 Staying aboard Queen Victoria

Cunard Voyage Info (V618D)

Day	Port	Arrives	Departs
Mon 14 Sep	Civitavecchia (depart Rome)	-	Evening
Tue 15 Sep 📌	At Sea GALA - RED AND GOLD	-	-
Wed 16 Sep	Marseille, France	Early morning	Evening
Thu 17 Sep	Villefranche, France (tender port)	Early morning	Evening

Fri 18 Sep	Genoa, Italy	Early morning	Late evening
Sat 19 Sep 📅	La Spezia (tours to Florence or Pisa) GALA - ROARING 20S	Early morning	Evening
Sun 20 Sep	At Sea	-	-
Mon 21 Sep	Civitavecchia (disembark)	Early morning	-

Ship Stats

Guests	Crew	Length
2,059	913	964.5 ft

Onboard - Things to Check Out

Venue	Notes
Gala evenings	Tue 15 Sep (Red and Gold) & Sat 19 Sep (Roaring 20s) - formal nights with themed menus, cocktails, decorations, music and dancing
Princess Grill Restaurant	Reserved table each night, elevated menu, sea views
Chart Room	Signature venue with zodiac-themed cocktails, dark woods, golden lighting
Queens Room	Fencing classes, Afternoon Tea, live music, dancing
Grill Suites Terrace/Courtyard	Outdoor sanctuary for Queens/Princess Grill Suite guests, sun loungers, drinks service
Gym	Included in fare, guests 16+, sea views, optional fitness classes/ personal training
Children's clubs	Under-18s, book via the My Voyage portal on board – games, arts and crafts, activities

Full deck plan: [View Deck Plan \(PDF\)](#)



Fair winds – the Queen Victoria at sea

Tuscany

21 – 22 September · Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais, Tavarnelle Val di Pesa

'I' buttons link to that place's official Instagram page.

9:00 AM

Collect Avis hire car - Mercedes Vito (booking ref NZ759149602) BOOKED

Civitavecchia Downtown, Via 16 Settembre 46, Cruise Ship Gate

[///snipe.nipped.miss](http://snipe.nipped.miss)

9:30 AM

Drive from Civitavecchia to Talamone (approx. 2h)

Directions: Civitavecchia to Talamone

[Directions](#)

11:30 AM

Lunch option: Agriturismo Buratta, TalamoneOPTIONAL

Directions: Agriturismo Buratta

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Directions](#)

1:00 PM

Drive from Talamone to Tuscany hotel (approx. 2h)

Directions: Talamone to Tuscany

[Directions](#)

3:00 PM

Arrive Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa Parking note: free onsite parking (contact hotel in advance to reserve a space)

📍 **Staying at Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais, Tuscany - Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa (+39 055 807 3333 · info@borgodicortefreda.com)**

9:00 AM

Potential Breakfast/Coffee: Il Caffè degli Amici

OPTIONAL

Directions from Hotel: Il Caffè degli Amici

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Directions](#)

4:00 PM

Potential Pastries/Coffee: Pasticceria La Golosa

OPTIONAL

Directions from Hotel: Pasticceria La Golosa

[Website](#)[Directions](#)

7:00 PM

Potential Restaurant: Triocco

OPTIONAL

Directions from Hotel: Triocco

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Directions](#)

📍 **Staying at Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais, Tuscany - Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa (+39 055 807 3333 · info@borgodicortefreda.com)**

Mercedes Drive Times - Monday 21 September

Leg	Approx. Distance	Approx. Drive Time	Notes
Civitavecchia (car collection) → Agriturismo Buratta, Talamone	~140 km	~2h 00m	Coastal route via SS1 Aurelia
Agriturismo Buratta, Talamone → Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais	~140 km	~2h 00m	Via SS223 (Siena-Grosseto), then north toward Tavarnelle
Total driving, via Talamone lunch stop	~280 km	~4h 00m driving (excl. lunch)	Direct route without the detour is approx. 230 km / 3h 10m

Estimates only – not a live routing query. Confirm via GPS/Google Maps on the day; actual times will vary with traffic and any stops.

Milan

23 September · iQ Hotel Milano

'I' buttons link to that place's official Instagram page.

9:00 AM -
12:10pm

Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Milan (approx. 3h 10m)

Directions: Tuscany to Milan

[Directions](#)

12:00 PM

Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan Check-in from 3:00pm - call ahead if arriving early: +39 02 8498 0810 Parking note: no private hotel parking - nearest partner garage ~100m away (fee applies, ask reception)

[Website](#) [I](#)

1:00 PM -
6:00pm

Free time / sightseeing in Milan (Duomo, Galleria Vittorio Emanuele II, Navigli) [TO CONFIRM](#)

Milan city centre

7:00 PM -
8:30pm

Dinner in Milan [TO BOOK](#)

Options: Cantine Milano, L'Immagine Bistrot, Casa Festa Alcolica - see Italy Map tab

[Website](#)

9:00 PM -
10:00pm

Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar [BOOKED](#)

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy (rooftop of iQ Hotel Milano)
Visit TripAdvisor: LiQuido Rooftop Bar

[Website](#) [Menu](#)

Alternative Options for 23 September

Four alternative full-day plans in place of the base Tuscany → Milan drive above – pick one.

Note on Option C: Venice is a significant detour east before doubling back west to Milan – approx. 610 km / ~6h 20m total driving (vs. ~1h 30m for the base plan, ~5h 15m for Option A, ~3h 40m for Option B). Also note Venice's historic centre is car-free, so the car must be left at Tronchetto or Piazzale Roma and the centre reached on foot/vaporetto. Worth confirming everyone's comfortable with the long day before booking.

OPTION A - LAKE COMO, LUNCH AT HARRY'S (23 SEP) [Total driving: 5h 15m]

6:00 AM -
7:00 AM

Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Bologna (approx. 1h 30m)

Directions: Tuscany to Bologna

[Directions](#)

7:30 AM -
8:30am

Arrive Bologna - Breakfast at Aroma Specialty Coffee

OPTIONAL

Via Portanova 12/b, 40123 Bologna, Italy Visit Website: Aroma Specialty Coffee (Il Piacere del Caffè)

[Website](#) [I](#)

8:30 AM -
11:00am

Drive from Bologna to Como (approx. 2h 30m)

Directions: Bologna to Como

[Directions](#)

11:00 AM

Arrive Como - Como-Brunate Funicular up to Brunate (approx. 7 min ride)

Piazza Alcide de Gasperi 4, 22100 Como, Italy Visit Website: Funicolare Como-Brunate

[Website](#)

11:30 AM -
12:30pm

Gelato with a view at Il Balcone sul Lago Café, Brunate

OPTIONAL

Via Pissarottino 26, 22034 Brunate (Como), Italy Visit Website: Il Balcone sul Lago (Facebook)

[Website](#)

12:30 PM

Drive from Como to Cernobbio (approx. 15 min)

Directions: Como to Cernobbio

[Directions](#)

1:00 PM -
2:30pm

Lunch at Harry's Bar, Cernobbio (Lake Como)

OPTIONAL

Via Besana 1, 22012 Cernobbio, Como, Italy Visit Website: Harry's Bar Cernobbio

[Website](#) [Menu](#) [I](#)

2:30 PM -
3:30pm

Drive from Lake Como to Milan (approx. 1h)

Directions: Lake Como to Milan

Directions

3:30 PM

Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan, Italy Check-in from 3:00pm - call ahead if arriving early: +39 02 8498 0810 Parking note: no private hotel parking - nearest partner garage ~100m away (fee applies, ask reception)

[Website](#)

[I](#)

**7:00 PM -
8:30pm**

Dinner in Milan [TO BOOK](#)

Options: Cantine Milano, L'Immagine Bistrot, Casa Festa Alcolica - see Italy Map tab

[Website](#)

**9:00 PM -
10:00pm**

Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar [BOOKED](#)

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy (rooftop of iQ Hotel Milano)
Visit TripAdvisor: LiQuido Rooftop Bar

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

📍 **iQ Hotel Milano, Milan (OPTION A) - Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan**
(+39 02 8498 0810 · info@iqhotelmilano.it)

OPTION B - FERRARI MUSEUM, MARANELLO (23 SEP) [Total driving: 3h 40m]

9:00 AM -
10:40am

Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Maranello (approx. 1h 40m)

Directions: Tuscany to Maranello

[Directions](#)

11:00 AM -
1:00pm

Visit Museo Ferrari, Maranello OPTIONAL

Via Dino Ferrari 43, 41053 Maranello (MO), Italy Visit Website: Museo Ferrari

[Website](#) [I](#)

1:00 PM -
2:00pm

Lunch near Ferrari Museum, Maranello OPTIONAL

2:00 PM -
4:00pm

Drive from Maranello to Milan (approx. 2h)

Directions: Maranello to Milan

[Directions](#)

4:00 PM

Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan, Italy Check-in from 3:00pm - call ahead if arriving early: +39 02 8498 0810 Parking note: no private hotel parking - nearest partner garage ~100m away (fee applies, ask reception)

[Website](#) [I](#)

7:00 PM -
8:30pm

Dinner in Milan TO BOOK

Options: Cantine Milano, L'Immagine Bistrot, Casa Festa Alcolica - see Italy Map tab

[Website](#)

9:00 PM -
10:00pm

Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar BOOKED

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy (rooftop of iQ Hotel Milano)
Visit TripAdvisor: LiQuido Rooftop Bar

[Website](#) [Menu](#)

📍 **iQ Hotel Milano, Milan (OPTION B) - Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan**
(+39 02 8498 0810 · info@iqhotelmilano.it)

OPTION C - VENICE LUNCH (23 SEP) [Total driving: 6h 20m]

6:00 AM -
9:30am

Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Venice (approx. 3h 30m)

Directions: Tuscany to Venice

[Directions](#)

9:30 AM

Arrive Venice - park at Tronchetto/Piazzale Roma (historic centre is car-free)

Tronchetto Parking, Isola del Tronchetto, 30135 Venice, Italy

[Website](#)

[Directions](#)

[I](#)

10:00 AM -
12:30pm

Free time - explore St Mark's Square & Rialto Bridge

OPTIONAL

12:30 PM -
2:00pm

Lunch in Venice

TO BOOK

[Website](#)

2:00 PM -
4:50pm

Drive from Venice to Milan (approx. 2h 50m)

Directions: Venice to Milan

[Directions](#)

5:00 PM

Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan, Italy Check-in from 3:00pm - call ahead if arriving early: +39 02 8498 0810 Parking note: no private hotel parking - nearest partner garage ~100m away (fee applies, ask reception)

[Website](#)

[I](#)

7:00 PM -
8:30pm

Dinner in Milan

TO BOOK

Options: Cantine Milano, L'Immagine Bistrot, Casa Festa Alcolica - see Italy Map tab

[Website](#)

9:00 PM -
10:00pm

Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar

BOOKED

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy (rooftop of iQ Hotel Milano)
Visit TripAdvisor: LiQuido Rooftop Bar

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

📍 **iQ Hotel Milano, Milan (OPTION C) - Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan**
(+39 02 8498 0810 · info@iqhotelmilano.it)

Potential Dinner Restaurants - Milan (23 September, all 3 plans)

All confirmed open on a Wednesday. The first three (Cantine Milano, L'Immagine, Casa Festa) were the original shortlist; the five below (Osteria Cornalia, Da Gigi, Osteria Nanin - Torriani, Giannino dal 1899, Pizza Shambò) are all 4-5 star Italian/Mediterranean options and much closer to the hotel (6-12 min walk, except Pizza Shambò at ~25 min). Hours and ratings sourced online - please reconfirm nearer the date. Distances are estimates only, from iQ Hotel Milano.

Cantine Milano

Open Wed: 12:00–3:00pm & 6:00pm–12:30am

Via Trau 1, 20159 Milano

□ ~1.8 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~20 min walk / ~7 min taxi · Walk via Via Sammartini, or short taxi

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Map](#)[I](#)

L'Immagine Ristorante Bistrot

Open Wed: 6:00–10:30pm (dinner only)

Via Varesina 61, 20156 Milano

□ ~4.5 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~15 min taxi / ~25 min metro + walk · Taxi, or M5 to Portello then ~10 min walk

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Map](#)[I](#)

Casa Festa - Pizzeria Alcolica

Open Wed: 11:30am–3:00pm & 6:30–11:30pm

Viale Bligny 42, 20136 Milano

□ ~4.8 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~18 min taxi / ~25 min metro · Taxi, or M3 toward Porta Romana/Lodi then ~8 min walk

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Map](#)[I](#)

Osteria Cornalia

TripAdvisor 4.6★ (362 reviews) · Open Wed: 12:00–3:00pm & 7:00pm–12:00am

Via Emilio Cornalia 16, 20124 Milano

□ ~0.6 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~8 min walk · Walk via Via Napo Torriani/Via Sammartini

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Map](#)[I](#)

Da Gigi Ristorante & Pizzeria

TheFork 8.9/10 · Open Wed: 12:00pm–11:00pm (non-stop)

Via Mauro Macchi 2, 20124 Milano

□ ~0.5 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~7 min walk · Walk via Via Vittor Pisani/Via Mauro Macchi

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Map](#)[I](#)

Osteria Nanin - Torriani

TripAdvisor 4.0★ (97 reviews) · Open Wed: 12:00–3:00pm & 7:00–10:45pm

Via Napo Torriani 10, 20124 Milano

📍 ~0.45 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~6 min walk · Walk via Via Napo Torriani

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

[Map](#)

[I](#)

Giannino dal 1899

TripAdvisor 4.3★ (303 reviews) · Open Wed: 12:00–3:00pm & 7:00–11:30pm

Via Vittor Pisani 6, 20124 Milano

📍 ~0.9 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~12 min walk · Walk via Via Vittor Pisani towards Piazza della Repubblica

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

[Map](#)

[I](#)

Pizza Shambò

TripAdvisor 4.6★ (229 reviews) · Open Wed: 12:00–3:00pm & 6:00–11:00pm

Via Edolo 1, 20125 Milano

📍 ~2.0 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~25 min walk / ~10 min taxi · Taxi, or bus/tram towards Via Porpora

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

[Map](#)

[I](#)

London

24 – 27 September · The Level at Meliá White House

'I' buttons link to that place's official Instagram page.

Getting Around: Tube Map & Travel Pass

Nearest station to the hotel: Great Portland Street (Circle, Hammersmith & City, Metropolitan lines) – approx. 2-3 min walk (~0.2 km), directly opposite The Level at Meliá White House.

[CLICK HERE for the Official TfL Tube Map \(PDF\)](#)

Getting a travel pass for the few days:

Contactless bank card / Apple Pay / Google Pay – simplest option for most visitors. Just tap in and out at the yellow readers on the Tube, buses, DLR, Overground and Elizabeth line – no need to buy anything in advance. Fares are automatically capped at around £8.90/day for Zones 1-2 (2026 rate), so a few days of sightseeing between Zone 1 (central London) and Zone 2 (Regent's Park/Camden area) should never cost more than the daily cap, even if you tap in and out a lot. Check your bank doesn't charge foreign transaction fees before relying on this.

Visitor Oyster card – order online before you fly (from about £5 plus however much credit you preload) or buy a standard Oyster card at any station on arrival (£7 refundable deposit). Works exactly like contactless with the same daily cap, and avoids any card fees or acceptance issues. Top up at station machines or the TfL Oyster app.

7 Day Travelcard – only worth considering if doing lots of travel every single day; for a 4-day stay like this one, pay-as-you-go (contactless or Oyster) with the daily cap works out cheaper and more flexible.

[Order a Visitor Oyster Card](#)

[Current TfL Fares](#)

📍 Sites within 20m

📍 Shops within 20m

12:00 PM

Return hire car - Mercedes Vito (booking ref NZ759149602) BOOKED

Milan Linate Airport Directions from iQ Hotel Milano

[Directions](#)

3:55 PM

Flight BA575 (British Airways) Milan Linate to London Heathrow (T5) - arrives 4:50pm

Milan Linate (LIN) to London Heathrow (LHR Terminal 5)

5:15 PM

Luxury Private Vehicle transfer to hotel - The Traveling Group / London Travel In (office +44 (0)20 8049 4300, emergency +44 7733 448902) (booking ref 190826)

BOOKED

Direct from Heathrow Terminal 5 (Meeting Point South, by Caffè Nero) to The Level at Meliá White House

6:00 PM

Arrive at The Level at Meliá White House - check in / drop bags (tight connection before dinner - see Audit)

Longford Street, Regent's Park, London NW1 3UP

[///baked.belly.neck](http://baked.belly.neck)

4:30 PM -
5:00 PM

Tapas and Gin for Deb (likely won't fit before dinner now BA575's official time is later - reconsider or move to another evening)

6:30 PM -
7:00 PM

Dinner at The Lighterman (confirmation 4NJL3Z4M6XN3)

BOOKED

3 Granary Square, London N1C 4BH (~1 mile / 20 min walk from hotel)

☎ 020 3846 3400

[///guides.riots.trader](http://guides.riots.trader)

(If we're early, we could grab a quick Gin & Pepsi downstairs first 😊)

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

[TripAdvisor](#)

[I](#)



WEBSITE

After The Lighterman: Nightcap Options

Estimates only – check live transit apps on the day.

The Parcel Yard

Grade I listed Fuller's pub inside King's Cross station itself

King's Cross Station, London N1 9AL

▮ From The Lighterman: ~8 min walking

▮ To The Melia: ~15 min - Circle/Hammersmith & City/Metropolitan line direct from King's Cross St Pancras to Great Portland Street (2 stops), then ~3 min walk

Map

Website

Menu

TripAdvisor



Big Chill Bar

Three-storey bar/club with a roof terrace, near the station

257-259 Pentonville Rd, London N1 9NL

▮ From The Lighterman: ~10 min walking

▮ To The Melia: ~15 min - Circle/Hammersmith & City/Metropolitan line direct from King's Cross St Pancras to Great Portland Street (2 stops), then ~3 min walk

Map

Website

TripAdvisor



The Racketeer

Independent, family-run cocktail and wine bar

105 King's Cross Rd, London WC1X 9LR

▮ From The Lighterman: ~12 min walking

▮ To The Melia: ~15 min - Circle/Hammersmith & City/Metropolitan line direct from King's Cross St Pancras to Great Portland Street (2 stops), then ~3 min walk

Map

Website

Menu

TripAdvisor



Spiritland King's Cross

Music-focused listening bar with a serious sound system and a well-executed cocktail list

9-10 Stable St, London N1C 4AB

▮ From The Lighterman: ~2 min walking

▮ To The Melia: ~15 min - Circle/Hammersmith & City/Metropolitan line direct from King's Cross St Pancras to Great Portland Street (2 stops), then ~3 min walk

Map

Website

TripAdvisor



▮ Staying at The Level at Melia White House - Longford Street, Regents Park, London NW1 3UP (+44 20 7391 3000 · melia.white.house@melia.com)

📍 Sites within 20m

🏪 Shops within 20m

8:00 AM -
8:30 AM

Breakfast at The Level

9:30 AM

Potential Victoria and Albert Museum

OPTIONAL

Directions from Hotel: V&A Museum

[///spots.mugs.cards](http://spots.mugs.cards)

Directions



12:00 PM

Potential Early Lunch at Harry's Knightsbridge

OPTIONAL

Directions from Hotel: Harry's Knightsbridge

[///icon.spends.third](http://icon.spends.third)

Menu

TripAdvisor

Directions

📄 *Harry's Bar-style venues take their name and dolce vita aesthetic from the original Harry's Bar in Venice, opened in 1931 - said to be where the Bellini cocktail and carpaccio were both invented. — [Wikipedia](#)*

1:00 PM

Free time wandering around Oxford Street

Oxford Street: oxfordstreet.co.uk

Website



POTENTIAL SHOPS TO LOOK AT:

Primark

Address

Website

14-28 Oxford Street, London W1D 1AR

Uniqlo

Address

Website

311 Oxford Street, London W1C 2HP

Selfridges

Address

Website

400 Oxford Street, London W1A 1AB

John Lewis

Address

Website

300 Oxford Street, London W1C 1DX

Hamleys

Address

Website

188-196 Regent Street, London W1B 5BT

Nike Town London

Address

Website

236 Oxford Street, London W1C 1DE

Adidas Flagship Store

Address

Website

425 Oxford Street, London W1C 2PG

Zara Oxford Street

[Address](#)[Website](#)

460-490 Oxford Street, London W1C 1AT

HMV

[Address](#)[Website](#)

363 Oxford Street, London W1C 2LA

Liberty London

[Address](#)[Website](#)

Great Marlborough St / Regent Street, London W1B 5AH

ALSO WORTH A LOOK:

RS No.9 Carnaby (Official Rolling Stones Store)

[///catch.future.librarian](#)

The Rolling Stones' official flagship store - clothing, vinyl and memorabilia, plus a Ronnie Wood art exhibition in the basement (~12 min walk via Regent Street/Carnaby Street)

9 Carnaby St, Carnaby, London W1F 9PE

☐ **Mon-Sat 11am-7pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

[Map](#)

**4:30 PM -
5:30 PM**

Dinner at Albert Schloss (booked, ref DMN-16959374828)

[BOOKED](#)

20-24 Shaftesbury Avenue, London W1D 7EU

☐ 020 8165 0000

[///assist.given.desk](#)[Menu](#)[TripAdvisor](#)[I](#)

WEBSITE

☐ *Albert's Schloss is one of a small chain of Alpine-Bavarian bier hall/cabaret venues from The New World Trading Company - the original opened in Manchester in 2017, with the Soho branch spread across several floors of a former Soho building near Piccadilly Circus. — Albert's Schloss*

6:30 PM

Need to be at Mousetrap by 6:30pm to get in

[BOOKED](#)

St Martin's Theatre, West Street, London WC2H 9NZ



WEBSITE

7:30 PM -
10pm

The Mousetrap begins (confirmed ref T071226139201)

BOOKED

St Martin's Theatre, West Street, London WC2H 9NZ

///trains.areas.nights

After The Mousetrap: Nightcap Options

Estimates only - check live transit apps on the day.

Covent Garden Social Club ///begins.jumpy.bake

Original London Cocktail Club venue, now independent

6-7 Great Newport St, London WC2H 7JB

□ From St Martin's Theatre: ~2 min walking

□ To The Melia: ~25 min - Piccadilly line from Leicester Square to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo to Great Portland Street, then ~3 min walk

Map

Website

TripAdvisor

Phoenix Artist Club ///meant.costs.defend

Theatrical cocktail bar and cabaret club beneath the Phoenix Theatre

1 Phoenix St, London WC2H 8BU

□ From St Martin's Theatre: ~3 min walking

□ To The Melia: ~25 min - Piccadilly line from Leicester Square to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo to Great Portland Street, then ~3 min walk

Map

Website

TripAdvisor

The Alchemist St Martin's Lane

Theatrical cocktails and post-theatre menu, right around the corner

63-66 St Martin's Ln, London WC2N 4JS

□ From St Martin's Theatre: ~4 min walking

□ To The Melia: ~25 min - Piccadilly line from Leicester Square to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo to Great Portland Street, then ~3 min walk

Map

Website

TripAdvisor

American Bar at The Savoy

The original 1893 cocktail bar - a London institution, book ahead

The Savoy, Strand, London WC2R 0EU

☐ **From St Martin's Theatre: ~10 min walking**

☐ **To The Melia: ~25 min - Piccadilly line from Covent Garden to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo to Great Portland Street, then ~3 min walk**

Map

Website

TripAdvisor

☐ **Staying at The Level at Melia White House - Longford Street, Regents Park, London NW1 3UP (+44 20 7391 3000 · melia.white.house@melia.com)**

📍 Sites within 20m

📍 Shops within 20m

7:30 AM -
8:00 AM

Breakfast at The Level

9:00 AM -
11:00 AMCombo: Tower of London (Crown Jewels) + Official Tower of London River Tour **TO CONFIRM**

Tower of London, EC3N 4AB Visit Website: Headout

[///swift.blitz.funds](http://swift.blitz.funds)

Website

TripAdvisor



11:30 AM

To be confirmed by Jennifer from Headout
(jennifer@inspire.headout.com) **TO CONFIRM**

3:00 PM

Need to be at Vaudeville Theatre by 3:00pm (1hr before show) **BOOKED**

Vaudeville Theatre, Strand, London WC2R 0NH

[///diner.donor.rails](http://diner.donor.rails)4:00 PM -
5:15pmSix the Musical begins - Stalls G8, G9, G10, G11 (4 adults, 1hr 15min) - Headout booking #32832547 (Gary Nicholson) **BOOKED**

Vaudeville Theatre, Strand, London WC2R 0NH



📄 *SIX started life as a low-budget student production at Cambridge University in 2017, written by two undergraduates, Toby Marlow and Lucy Moss, who were still in their early twenties. It transferred to the West End in 2019 and has since played on Broadway and around the world. — Wikipedia*

5:30 PM -
6:30pmVisit Waterstones Piccadilly **OPTIONAL**

Directions from Hotel: Waterstones Piccadilly

[///blank.buns.bump](http://blank.buns.bump)

Website

Directions



📄 *This shop opened in 1936 as Simpsons of Piccadilly, then Britain's largest menswear store, designed by modernist architect Joseph Emberton. Waterstones took it over in 1999 and it's now Europe's largest bookshop, with over 8 miles of shelving across 6 floors. — Wikipedia*

6:45pm -
8:15pmDinner at Hard Rock Cafe London (confirmation #496211, via OpenTable) **BOOKED**

150 Old Park Lane, Mayfair, London W1K 1QZ

☎ 0044 20 7514 1700

[///month.wakes.tests](http://month.wakes.tests)



WEBSITE

After Hard Rock: Nightcap Options

Estimates only – check live transit apps on the day.

4 bars near Hard Rock Cafe:

Rivoli Bar at The Ritz

<http://jazz.choice.factories>

Art Deco hotel cocktail bar - Ritz signature serves, entered via the main lobby

150 Piccadilly, London W1J 9BR

From Hard Rock: ~15 min walking

To The Melia: ~25 min - walk to Green Park, Piccadilly/Victoria line to Oxford Circus, change to Bakerloo, then ~5 min walk

[Map](#)[Website](#)[TripAdvisor](#)

The Connaught Bar

<http://tamed.zooms.pest>

World-famous cocktail bar - a Mayfair institution, book ahead

Carlos Pl, Mayfair, London W1K 2AL

From Hard Rock: ~12 min walking

To The Melia: ~25 min - walk to Bond Street, Central line to Oxford Circus, change to Bakerloo, then ~5 min walk

[Map](#)[Website](#)[TripAdvisor](#)

Dukes Bar

<http://less.candy.award>

Legendary martini bar (since 1908) - birthplace of the 'Vesper' martini style

35 St James's Pl, London SW1A 1NY

From Hard Rock: ~15 min walking

To The Melia: ~30 min - walk to Green Park, Piccadilly line to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo, then ~5 min walk

[Map](#)[Website](#)[TripAdvisor](#)

Blue Bar at The Berkeley

<http://flame.fears.retail>

Sophisticated hotel cocktail bar in Knightsbridge, David Collins-designed interior
Wilton Pl, Knightsbridge, London SW1X 7RL

▮ **From Hard Rock: ~26 min walking**

▮ **To The Melia: ~30 min - walk to Hyde Park Corner, Piccadilly line to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo, then ~5 min walk**

Map

Website

TripAdvisor

4 bars near The Melia:

The Lucky Pig

Speakeasy-style basement cocktail bar, just off Great Portland Street

5 Clipstone St, London W1W 6BB

▮ **From The Melia: ~6 min walking**

▮ **To Hard Rock: ~25 min - Bakerloo line from Regent's Park/Great Portland Street to Piccadilly Circus, change to Piccadilly line to Hyde Park Corner, then ~5 min walk**

Map

Website

TripAdvisor

The George, Fitzrovia

[///moss.fend.agrees](http://moss.fend.agrees)

Grade II listed 18th-century corner pub with an ornate Italianate facade

55 Great Portland St, London W1W 7LQ

▮ **From The Melia: ~5 min walking**

▮ **To Hard Rock: ~25 min - Bakerloo line from Regent's Park/Great Portland Street to Piccadilly Circus, change to Piccadilly line to Hyde Park Corner, then ~5 min walk**

Map

Website

TripAdvisor

Artesian at The Langham

[///nights.truly.squad](http://nights.truly.squad)

Multi-award-winning hotel cocktail bar - voted World's Best Bar for years running

1c Portland Pl, London W1B 1JA

▮ **From The Melia: ~13 min walking**

▮ **To Hard Rock: ~20 min - Bakerloo line from Regent's Park/Great Portland Street to Piccadilly Circus, change to Piccadilly line to Hyde Park Corner, then ~5 min walk**

Map

Website

Menu

TripAdvisor

The Social

Long-running Fitzrovia bar and music venue, intimate upstairs bar plus basement gigs/DJ sets

5 Little Portland St, London W1W 7JD

📍 **From The Melia: ~9 min walking**

📍 **To Hard Rock: ~25 min - Bakerloo line from Regent's Park/Great Portland Street to Piccadilly Circus, change to Piccadilly line to Hyde Park Corner, then ~5 min walk**

[Map](#)

[Website](#)

[TripAdvisor](#)

📍 **Staying at The Level at Melia White House - Longford Street, Regents Park, London NW1 3UP (+44 20 7391 3000 · melia.white.house@melia.com)**

Sunday 27th September (Day 18)

AIR TRAVEL - DEPART LHR (T5) 10.00PM

📍 Sites within 20m

📍 Shops within 20m

8:00 AM - Breakfast at The Level
8:30 AM

7:00 PM Leave for Airport

10:00 PM Depart London Heathrow (T5) at 10.00pm - BA15 (British Airways) LHR (T5) to SIN (T1) PE, then BA15 SIN (T1) to SYD (T1) PE

Heathrow Airport, Hounslow TW6 1EW

Option 1: Lunch at The Castle or The Sir John Oldcastle, Farringdon

Two pub options right by Farringdon station – a laid-back lunch stop before heading to the airport.

Getting there: Great Portland Street → Farringdon on the Metropolitan/Circle/Hammersmith & City line, direct (no change), ~6 min journey, then ~2-3 min walk from Farringdon station to either pub.

The Castle [///range.return.colleague](http://range.return.colleague)

Grade II listed pub & restaurant, est. 1865 – British pub food, craft beer, full bar, only pawnbroker's licence in London

34-35 Cowcross St, Farringdon, London EC1M 6DB

🕒 Sun 12pm-10:30pm (check ahead for any Sept 2026 changes)

📞 +44 20 7553 7621

Website

Menu

Map

I

The Sir John Oldcastle [///twin.milk.hurry](http://twin.milk.hurry)

JD Wetherspoon pub, named after the historical figure said to have inspired Shakespeare's Falstaff – British pub food, full bar, right next to Farringdon station

29-35 Farringdon Rd, Farringdon, London EC1M 3JF

🕒 Sun 8am-11:30pm (check ahead for any Sept 2026 changes)

📞 020 7242 1013

Website

Map

TripAdvisor

Things to Consider - London

Day	Item	Status	Notes
Sat (26)	Tower of London + Crown Jewels + River Tour (combo) TO DO	TO CONFIRM	To be confirmed by Jennifer from Headout (jennifer@inspire.headout.com) - see Links tab for tour detail from Deb
Sat (26)	Six the Musical tickets	BOOKED	Vaudeville Theatre, 4:00pm (1hr 15min), Stalls G8-G11 (4 adults) - Headout booking #32832547, purchased by Gary Nicholson
Sat (26)	Book dinner reservation - Hard Rock Cafe London TO DO	TO BOOK	150 Old Park Lane, Mayfair, London W1K 1QZ - cafe.hardrock.com/london - after the Six show (ends 5:15pm)
Sun (27)	Confirm transfer to airport TO DO	TO CONFIRM	Leaving hotel 7:00pm for 10:00pm LHR departure

Within 20 Minutes of the Melia on foot

20 things to do within roughly a 20-minute walk of The Level at Meliá White House, Longford Street. Walk times are estimates – check live maps nearer the time.

The Regent's Park

Royal park right across the road - gardens, boating lake, rose garden (~1-2 min walk)

Chester Rd, London NW1 4NR

☎ 0300 061 2300

Map

London Zoo

World-famous zoo, inside Regent's Park (~15 min walk)

Outer Circle, Regent's Park, London NW1 4RY

☎ 0344 225 1826

Map

Regent's Park Open Air Theatre

Outdoor theatre - plays, concerts, events, seasonal (~15 min walk)

Inner Circle, Regent's Park, London NW1 4NU

☎ 0333 400 3562

Map

Sherlock Holmes Museum

Recreated Victorian rooms at the famous '221B' address (~10 min walk)

221b Baker St, London NW1 6XE

☎ 020 7224 3688

Map

Madame Tussauds London

Waxworks - celebrities, royals, film characters (~10 min walk)

Marylebone Rd, London NW1 5LR

☎ 0207 487 0350

Map

Baker Street

Iconic street, tube station, shops and cafes (~9 min walk)

Baker St, London NW1

Map

Marylebone High Street

Boutique shops, cafes and Daunt Books' famous store (~14 min walk)

Marylebone High St, London W1U

Map

The Wallace Collection

Free national museum - art, armour and furniture (~16 min walk)

Hertford House, Manchester Square, London W1U 3BN

☎ 020 7563 9500

Map

BBC Broadcasting House

Iconic Art Deco home of the BBC (~9 min walk)

Portland Pl, London W1A 1AA

☎ 0370 010 0222

Map

All Souls Church, Langham Place

Nash's striking circular church next to the BBC (~9 min walk)

2 All Souls Pl, London W1B 3DA

☎ 020 7580 3522

Map

RIBA (Royal Institute of British Architects)

Free exhibitions, cafe and bookshop (~8 min walk)

66 Portland Pl, London W1B 1AD

☎ +44 (0)20 7307 5355

Map

Great Portland Street shops & cafes

Right outside the hotel - cafes, restaurants, shops (~1-2 min walk)

Great Portland St, London W1W

Map

Charlotte Street, Fitzrovia

Buzzy strip of restaurants and bars (~15 min walk)

Charlotte St, London W1T

Map

Regent's Canal towpath

Scenic canal walk along the edge of Regent's Park (~12 min walk)

Regent's Canal, London NW1

Map

Euston Square & UCL area

University quarter with green squares (~10 min walk)

Euston Square Gardens, London NW1 2EF

Map

Wellcome Collection

Free museum exploring medicine, art and science (~10 min walk)

183 Euston Rd, London NW1 2BE

☎ 020 7611 2222

Map

London Central Mosque

Striking gold-domed mosque on the edge of Regent's Park (~14 min walk)

146 Park Rd, London NW8 7RG

☎ 020 7725 2152

Map

Cumberland Terrace

One of Regent's Park's grandest Nash terraces (~12 min walk)

Cumberland Terrace, London NW1 4HE

Map

Oxford Circus & top of Oxford Street

Flagship shopping - Regent Street meets Oxford Street (~17 min walk)

Oxford Circus, London W1B

Map

Primrose Hill

Park hill with panoramic skyline views over London (~19 min walk)

Primrose Hill, London NW1 4NR

20 Shops to See in London

A top-20 pick of iconic London shops, department stores and markets – not all are near the hotel, so check travel time before heading out.

Harrods

Flagship luxury department store, iconic since 1834

87-135 Brompton Rd, Knightsbridge, London SW1X 7XL

☎ **Mon-Sat 10am-9pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☎ **+44 (0)20 7730 1234**

[Map](#)

Selfridges

Legendary Oxford Street department store

400 Oxford St, London W1A 1AB

☎ **Mon-Fri 10am-10pm, Sat 10am-9pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☎ **020 7160 6222**

[Map](#)

Liberty London

Tudor-revival department store, famous for its prints

Great Marlborough St, London W1B 5AH

☎ **Mon-Sat 10am-8pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☎ **020 7734 1234**

[Map](#)

Fortnum & Mason

Royal grocer since 1707 - hampers, tea, food halls

181 Piccadilly, London W1A 1ER

☎ **Mon-Sat 10am-8pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☎ **020 7734 8040**

Map

Hamleys

World's oldest and largest toy shop

188-196 Regent St, London W1B 5BT

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-9pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **0371 704 1977**

Map

John Lewis Oxford Street

Flagship department store

300 Oxford St, London W1C 1DX

☐ **Mon-Wed & Fri-Sat 9:30am-8pm, Thu 9:30am-9pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **0345 608 0677**

Map

Daunt Books Marylebone

Beautiful Edwardian travel bookshop

83 Marylebone High St, London W1U 4QW

☐ **Mon-Sat 9am-7:30pm, Sun 11am-6pm**

☐ **020 7224 2295**

Map

Waterstones Piccadilly

Europe's largest bookshop

203-206 Piccadilly, London W1J 9HD

☐ **Mon-Sat 9am-10pm, Sun 12pm-6:30pm**

☐ **020 7851 2400**

Map

Burlington Arcade

Historic covered luxury shopping arcade

51 Piccadilly, London W1J 0QJ

☐ **Mon-Sat 8am-8pm, Sun 11am-6pm**

☎ 020 7493 1764

Map

Regent Street

Iconic curved shopping street, flagship stores

Regent St, London W1B

☎ Varies by store (most 10am-7/8pm, Sun 12pm-6pm)

☎ Varies by store

Map

Camden Market

Alternative fashion, crafts and street food stalls

Camden Lock Pl, London NW1 8AF

☎ Daily 10am-6pm (some stalls/evenings vary)

☎ 020 3763 9999

Map

Portobello Road Market

Antiques, vintage and fashion market

Portobello Rd, London W11 1LJ

☎ Mon-Sat approx. 8am-7pm (Sat is main trading day)

☎ 020 7727 7684

Map

Borough Market

Historic food market

8 Southwark St, London SE1 1TL

☎ Mon-Fri 10am-5pm (limited), Sat 8am-5pm, Sun 10am-3pm

☎ 020 7407 1002

Map

Covent Garden Market

Boutiques, crafts market, street performers

The Piazza, Covent Garden, London WC2E 8RF

☐ **Mon-Fri 10am-8pm, Sat 9am-8pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7395 3765**

Map

New Bond Street

Luxury flagship boutiques - Chanel, Tiffany & more

New Bond St, London W1S

☐ **Varies by store (most 10am-6/7pm, Sun 12pm-6pm)**

☐ **Varies by store**

Map

Foyles Charing Cross Road

Famous independent bookshop

107 Charing Cross Rd, London WC2H 0DT

☐ **Mon-Sat 9:30am-9pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☐ **020 7437 5660**

Map

M&M's World

Multi-storey confectionery flagship store

1 Swiss Ct, London W1D 6AP

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-9pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7025 7171**

Map

LEGO Store Leicester Square

Flagship LEGO store

3 Swiss Ct, London W1D 6AP

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-10pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7839 3480**

Map

Apple Store Regent Street

Flagship Apple store in a historic building

235 Regent St, London W1B 2EL

☐ **Mon-Fri 10am-9pm, Sat 10am-8pm, Sun 10am-6pm**

☐ **020 7153 9000**

[Map](#)

Primark Oxford Street

World's largest Primark store

14-28 Oxford St, Fitzrovia, London W1D 1AU

☐ **Mon-Sat 8am-10pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☐ **020 7580 5510**

[Map](#)

20 Shops within 15 Minutes of Piccadilly Circus

20 shops, arcades and shopping streets all within roughly a 15-minute walk of Piccadilly Circus tube station. Walk times are estimates – check live maps nearer the time.

Fortnum & Mason

Royal grocer since 1707 - hampers, tea, food halls (~2 min walk)

181 Piccadilly, London W1A 1ER

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-8pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☐ **020 7734 8040**

[Map](#)

Hatchards

UK's oldest bookshop (est. 1797), five floors, right next to Fortnum's (~2 min walk)

187 Piccadilly, London W1J 9LE

☐ **Mon-Sat 9:30am-8pm, Sun 10:30am-6pm**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Waterstones Piccadilly

Europe's largest bookshop (~3 min walk)

203-206 Piccadilly, London W1J 9HD

☐ **Mon-Sat 9am-10pm, Sun 12pm-6:30pm**

☐ **020 7851 2400**

[Map](#)

Burlington Arcade

Historic 1819 covered luxury shopping arcade with uniformed Beadles (~4 min walk)

51 Piccadilly, London W1J 0QJ

☐ **Mon-Sat 8am-8pm, Sun 11am-6pm**

☐ **020 7493 1764**

[Map](#)

Penhaligon's

British perfumer established 1870, inside Burlington Arcade (~4 min walk)

16-17 Burlington Arcade, London W1J 0PL

☐ **Check ahead - hours vary**

☐ **020 7629 1416**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Prince's Arcade

Victorian shopping arcade linking Piccadilly to Jermyn Street (~4 min walk)

8-10 Prince's Arcade, Piccadilly, London SW1Y 6DS

☐ **Varies by store**

[Map](#)

Lillywhites

Flagship five-floor sports store, oldest in the UK (est. 1863), right on Piccadilly Circus (~1 min walk)

24-36 Regent St, London SW1Y 4QF

☐ **Mon-Sat 9:30am-10pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **0844 332 5602**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Hamleys

World's oldest and largest toy shop (~7 min walk)

188-196 Regent St, London W1B 5BT

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-9pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **0371 704 1977**

[Map](#)

Apple Store Regent Street

Flagship Apple store in a historic building (~9 min walk)

235 Regent St, London W1B 2EL

☐ **Mon-Fri 10am-9pm, Sat 10am-8pm, Sun 10am-6pm**

☐ **020 7153 9000**

[Map](#)

Liberty London

Tudor-revival department store, famous for its prints (~8 min walk)

Great Marlborough St, London W1B 5AH

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-8pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7734 1234**

[Map](#)

Regent Street

Iconic curved shopping street, flagship stores end to end (~1-9 min walk)

Regent St, London W1B

☐ **Varies by store (most 10am-7/8pm, Sun 12pm-6pm)**

[Map](#)

Carnaby Street

Swinging-60s fashion street, now independent boutiques and big brands (~8 min walk)

Carnaby St, London W1F

☐ **Varies by store (most 10am-7pm, Sun 12-6pm)**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Jermyn Street

London's shirtmaking street - Turnbull & Asser and other historic tailors (~5 min walk)

71-72 Jermyn St, London SW1Y 6PF

☐ **Mon-Fri 9am-6pm, Sat 9:30am-6pm (closed Sun)**

☎ 020 7808 3000

Website

Map

Savile Row

The world-famous bespoke tailoring street (~10 min walk)

32 Old Burlington St / 17 Clifford St, London W1S

☎ Mon-Fri 8:30am-5pm (haberdashery also open Sat 10:30am-4pm)

Website

Map

M&M's World

Multi-storey confectionery flagship store, Leicester Square (~6 min walk)

1 Swiss Ct, London W1D 6AP

☎ Mon-Sat 10am-9pm, Sun 12pm-6pm

☎ 020 7025 7171

Map

LEGO Store Leicester Square

Flagship LEGO store (~6 min walk)

3 Swiss Ct, London W1D 6AP

☎ Mon-Sat 10am-10pm, Sun 12pm-6pm

☎ 020 7839 3480

Map

Foyles Charing Cross Road

Famous independent bookshop, five floors (~9 min walk)

107 Charing Cross Rd, London WC2H 0DT

☎ Mon-Sat 9:30am-9pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm

☎ 020 7437 5660

Map

Covent Garden Market

Boutiques, craft market, street performers (~10 min walk)

The Piazza, Covent Garden, London WC2E 8RF

☎ Mon-Fri 10am-8pm, Sat 9am-8pm, Sun 12pm-6pm

☎ 020 7395 3765

Map

New Bond Street

Luxury flagship boutiques - Chanel, Tiffany & more (~10 min walk)

New Bond St, London W1S

☎ **Varies by store (most 10am-6/7pm, Sun 12pm-6pm)**

Map

St James's Market

Small modern food-and-shopping precinct behind Waterstones (~4 min walk)

St James's Market, London SW1Y 4AH

☎ **Varies by outlet**

Map

20 Things to Do within 15 Minutes of Piccadilly Circus

20 sights, galleries, parks and landmarks all within roughly a 15-minute walk of Piccadilly Circus tube station. Walk times are estimates – check live maps nearer the time.

Piccadilly Circus & the Shaftesbury Memorial (Eros) ///tidy.loyal.public

The famous statue and video-screen hub itself - starting point for everything below

Piccadilly Circus, London W1J

Map

St James's Church Piccadilly

Wren-designed church (1684) with a leafy courtyard and craft/antiques market most days

197 Piccadilly, London W1J 9LL

Website

Map

Royal Academy of Arts

Major art exhibitions inside historic Burlington House - free courtyard and permanent collection displays

Burlington House, Piccadilly, London W1J 0BD

☐ **Tue-Thu & Sun 10am-6pm, Fri-Sat 10am-9pm (closed Mon)**

☐ **020 7300 8090**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Leicester Square

Cinemas, half-price theatre ticket booth (TKTS) and street entertainers

Leicester Square, London WC2H 7NA

[Map](#)

Chinatown London

Pagoda gates, dim sum and Chinese bakeries around Gerrard Street

Gerrard St, London W1D 5PW

[Map](#)

Soho Square

Small leafy square in the heart of Soho, good for a sit-down break

Soho Square, London W1D 3QP

[Map](#)

Trafalgar Square

Nelson's Column, the four bronze lions and the famous fourth plinth artwork

Trafalgar Square, London WC2N 5DN

[Map](#)

National Gallery

World-class collection of Western European paintings - free entry to the permanent collection

Trafalgar Square, London WC2N 5DN

☐ **Daily 10am-6pm, Fri until 9pm**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

National Portrait Gallery

Portraits of famous Britons through history - free entry to the permanent collection

St Martin's Place, London WC2H 0HE

🕒 **Daily 10:30am-6pm, Fri-Sat until 9pm**

[Website](#)[Map](#)

St James's Park

One of London's prettiest royal parks - lake, pelicans, views to Buckingham Palace

St James's Park, London SW1A 2BJ

[Map](#)

Green Park

Quiet, tree-lined royal park between Piccadilly and Buckingham Palace

Green Park, London SW1A 1BW

[Map](#)

The Ritz London

Legendary 1906 hotel - iconic Louis XVI-style facade, famous afternoon tea (book well ahead)

150 Piccadilly, London W1J 9BR

[Website](#)[Map](#)

Spencer House

Princess Diana's ancestral family home - 18th-century state rooms, open select days

27 St James's Place, London SW1A 1NR

[Website](#)[Map](#)

Christie's

World-famous auction house - free public viewing rooms before major sales

8 King St, St James's, London SW1Y 6QT

[Website](#)[Map](#)

Handel & Hendrix House

Composer Handel's Georgian home next door to where Jimi Hendrix once lived - small museum

25 Brook St, London W1K 4HB

☐ **Wed-Sun 10am-5pm (closed Mon-Tue)**

☐ **020 7495 1685**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

The Photographers' Gallery

London's leading photography gallery - free exhibitions on the ground floor

16-18 Ramillies St, London W1F 7LW

☐ **Mon-Wed & Sat 10:30am-6pm, Thu-Fri 10:30am-8pm, Sun 11am-6pm**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Covent Garden Piazza

Street performers, market stalls and the Royal Opera House

The Piazza, Covent Garden, London WC2E 8RF

[Map](#)

Shaftesbury Avenue Theatreland

London's main theatre strip - Lyric, Apollo, Gielgud, Queen's and more, all in a row

Shaftesbury Ave, London W1D

[Map](#)

Waterloo Place & Duke of York Column

Grand statue-lined avenue with steps down toward The Mall and St James's Park

Waterloo Place, London SW1Y 5AY

[Map](#)

Berkeley Square

Mayfair's grand garden square, lined with plane trees - of 'nightingale sang' fame

Berkeley Square, London W1J 6BR

[Map](#)

Cars Baby Cars

Supercar and luxury-marque showrooms clustered around Berkeley Square, Mayfair – all within roughly a 15-minute walk of Piccadilly Circus.

Rolls-Royce Motor Cars London

Flagship Rolls-Royce showroom on the corner of Berkeley Street and Stratton Street (~10 min walk)

50 Berkeley St, London W1J 8HD

[Website](#)[Map](#)

Jack Barclay Bentley

London's oldest Bentley dealership (since 1927), on Berkeley Square (~10 min walk)

18 Berkeley Square, London W1J 6AE

[Website](#)[Map](#)

H.R. Owen Ferrari Mayfair

Official Ferrari flagship showroom, Berkeley Square (~10 min walk)

15-17 Berkeley Square, London W1J 6EG

[Website](#)[Map](#)

Lamborghini Mayfair

H.R. Owen flagship Lamborghini showroom, Berkeley Square (~10 min walk)

20 Berkeley Square, London W1J 6BR

[Website](#)[Map](#)

Volvo Cars Central London

Official Volvo showroom and service centre, Swiss Cottage (a drive/tube ride, not walkable)

1 Northways Parade, Finchley Rd, London NW3 5EN

[Website](#)[Map](#)

Mercedes-Benz of Chelsea

Official Mercedes-Benz showroom on Wandsworth Bridge (a drive/tube ride, not walkable)

Jews Row, Wandsworth, London SW18 1TB

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

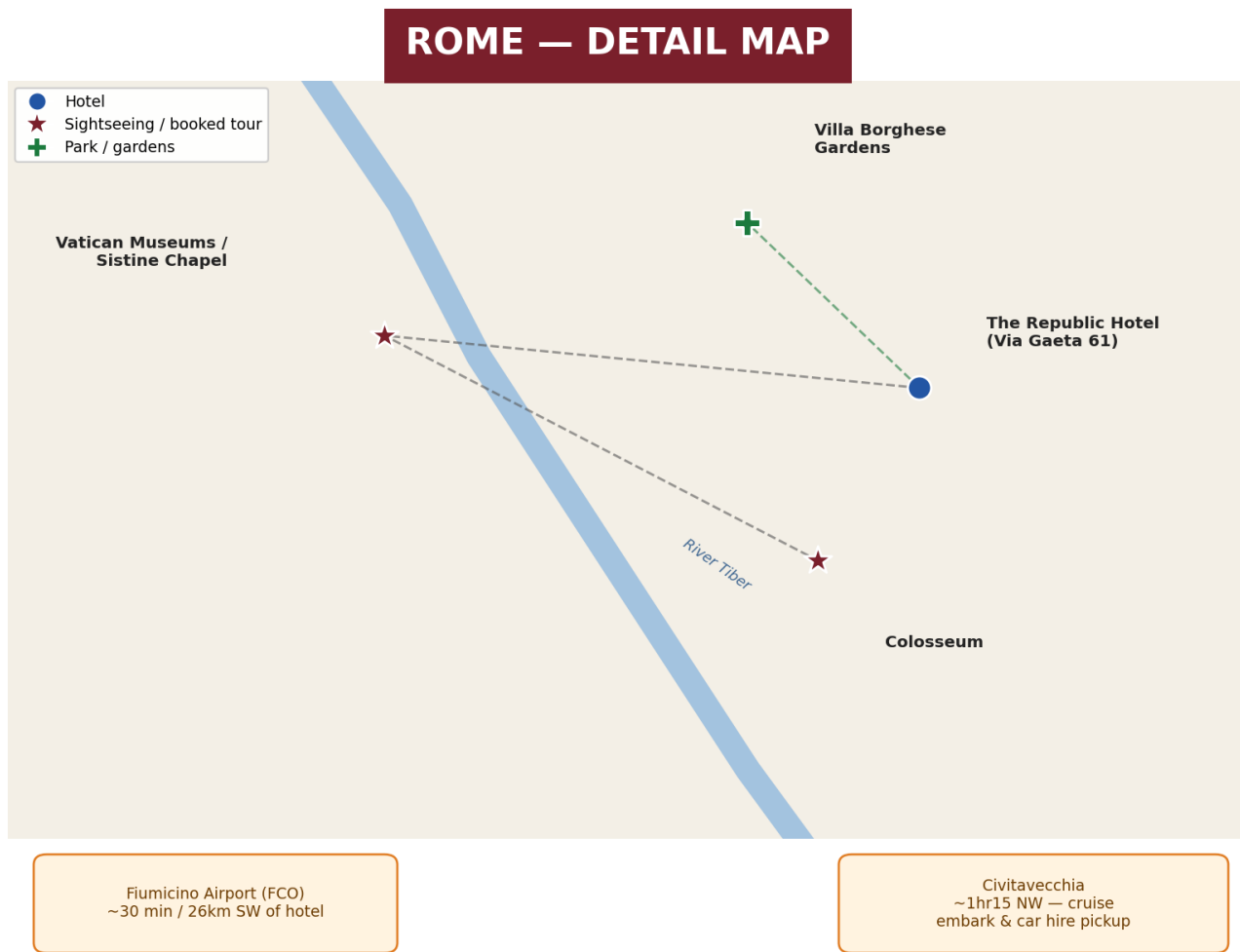
Rolls-Royce, Bentley, Ferrari and Lamborghini are all genuinely walkable from Piccadilly Circus around Berkeley Square, Mayfair. Volvo and Mercedes-Benz are London dealerships but sit further out (Swiss Cottage and Wandsworth) - worth a taxi/tube rather than a walk. Zeekr doesn't have a UK showroom yet - its London launch is expected later in 2026.

Places & Maps

Schematic maps and place lists from the itinerary, with website and review links.

'I' buttons link to that place's official Instagram page.

Rome



Schematic map (not to scale / not live map tiles) — for trip planning reference only

Schematic map - approximate positions, not to scale

The Republic Hotel

Hotel (11-14 Sep)

Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome

Map

Fiumicino Airport (FCO)

Airport - arrival

Fiumicino Airport, Rome

Map

I

Vatican Museums / Sistine Chapel

Sightseeing - booked (Sat 12 Sep, 7:15am, 4hrs)

Vatican Museums, Vatican City

Map

I

Villa Borghese Gardens

Sightseeing (Fri 11 Sep, 3-5pm)

Villa Borghese, Rome, Italy

Map

Colosseum

Sightseeing - booked (Sun 13 Sep, 3:30pm, 3.5hrs, Arena Floor & VIP Caesar's Palace)

Piazza del Colosseo, 1, 00184 Roma RM, Italy

Map

I

Civitavecchia

Cruise embark / car hire (Mon 14 & Mon 21 Sep)

Via 16 Settembre 46, Civitavecchia

Map

Cantina Cantarini da Mario

Restaurant candidate - veal scaloppine al limone (Tripadvisor 3.9/5)

Piazza Sallustio 24, 00187 Roma

Menu

Map

Reviews

I

Girarrosto Fiorentino

Restaurant candidate - veal specialties (Google 4.4/5)

Via Sicilia 46, 00187 Roma

[Menu](#)[Map](#)[Reviews](#)[I](#)

Colline Emiliane

Restaurant candidate - veal specialties (Tripadvisor 4.5/5)

Via degli Avignonesi 22, 00187 Roma

[Menu](#)[Map](#)[Reviews](#)[I](#)

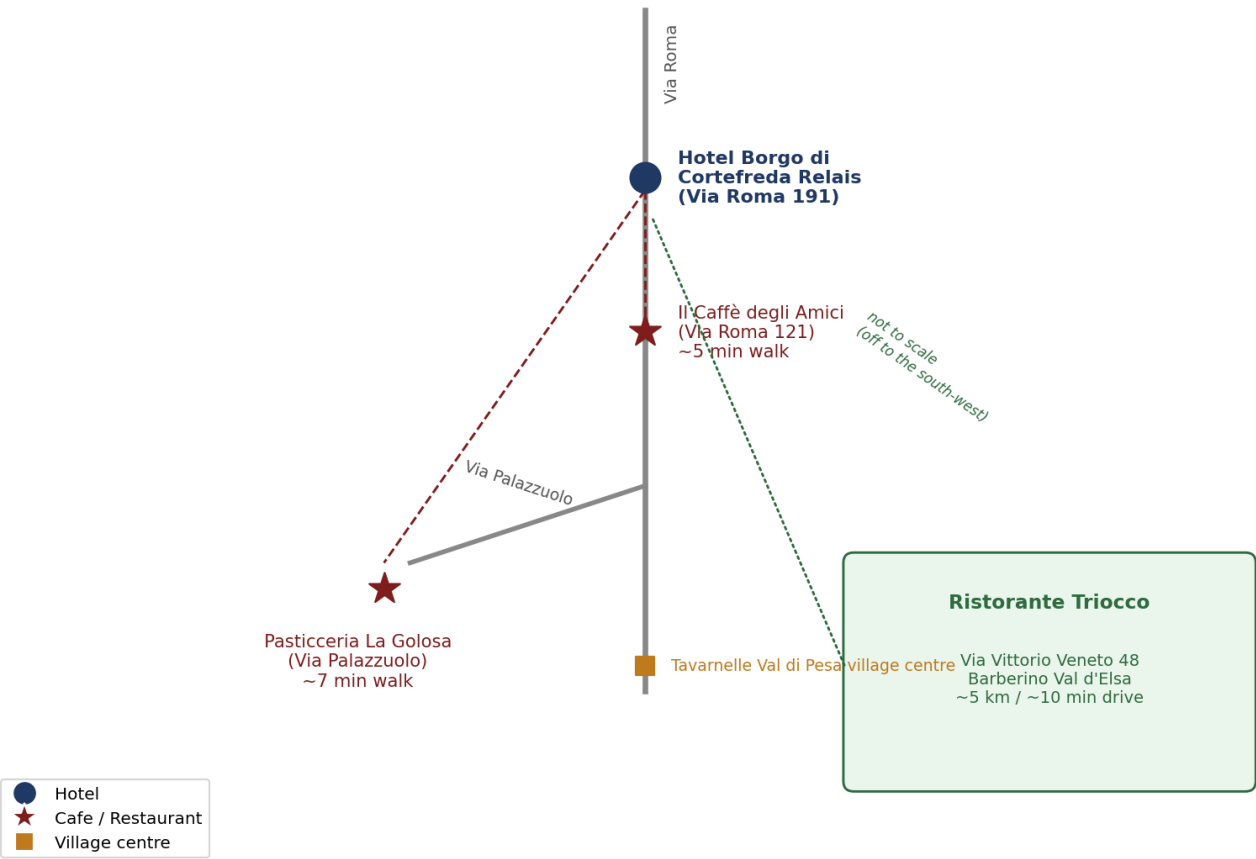
Trattoria Monti

Restaurant candidate - classic Marche/Roman cuisine (top ~4% of Rome restaurants)

Via di San Vito 13/a, 00185 Roma

[Menu](#)[Map](#)[Reviews](#)

Tavarnelle Val di Pesa — Hotel Area



Schematic map – approximate positions, not to scale

Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Hotel (14-16 Sep)

Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa

Map I

Il Caffè degli Amici

Cafe/restaurant - potential place to go (Tripadvisor 4.7/5, 562 reviews)

Via Roma 121, 50028 Tavarnelle Val di Pesa

Menu Map Reviews I

Pasticceria La Golosa

Pastry shop/cafe - potential place to go (Tripadvisor 4.4/5, 31 reviews)

Via Palazzuolo, 50028 Tavarnelle Val di Pesa

Map

Reviews

Ristorante Triocco

Dinner option - potential place to go (Tripadvisor 4.6/5, 334 reviews, #2 of 20 in Barberino Val d'Elsa)

Via Vittorio Veneto 48, 50021 Barberino Val d'Elsa, Barberino Tavarnelle

Menu

Map

Reviews

I

Agriturismo Buratta

Lunch option - potential stop en route from Civitavecchia (Tripadvisor 4.0/5, 832 reviews, #1 of 19 in Talamone)

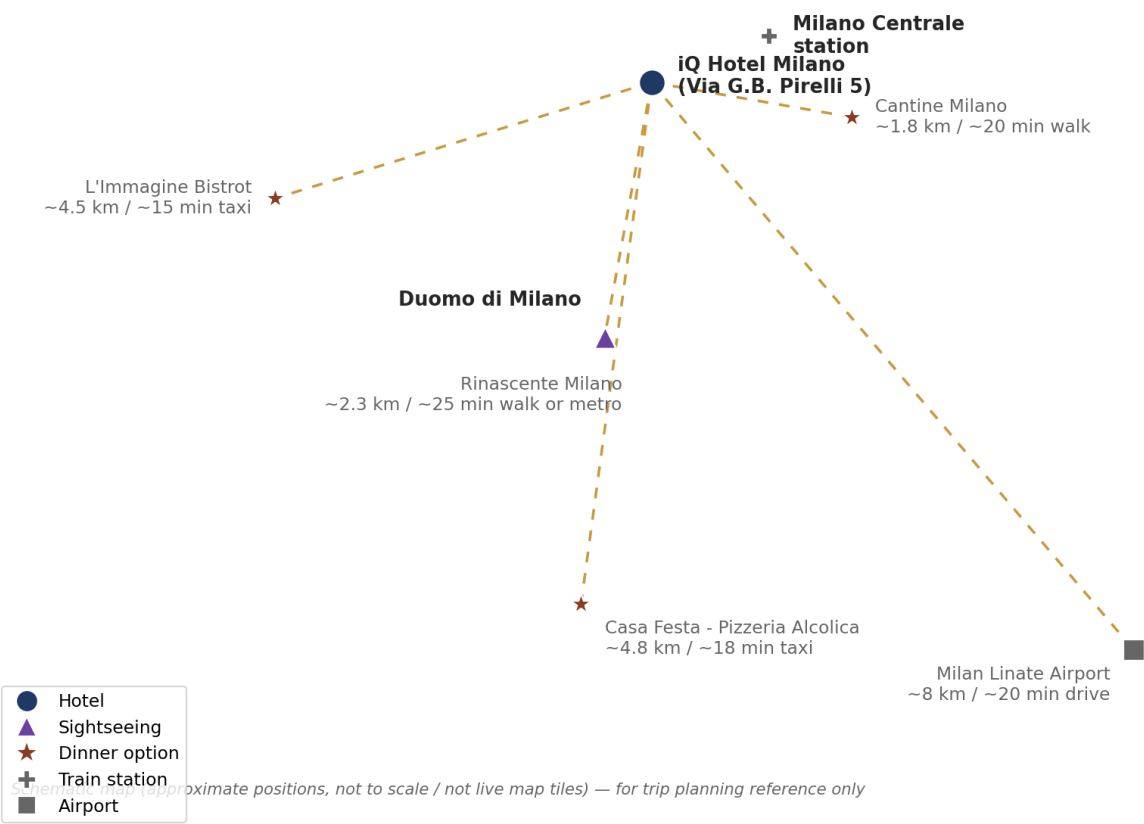
Strada Vicinale delle Casacce, 65, 58010 Talamone, Orbetello

Menu

Map

Reviews

Milan — Detail Map



Schematic map – approximate positions, not to scale

iQ Hotel Milano

Hotel

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan

Map

I

Milan Linate Airport

Airport (car return)

Milan Linate Airport

Map

I

Rinascente Milano

Department store / Shopping

Map

I

Fornasetti (flagship store)

Potential shop - official Fornasetti flagship, iconic Italian design house (~3.5 km / ~45 min walk from hotel, or ~10-15 min by taxi/metro)

Via Senato 2, 20121 Milan (near Corso Venezia)

🕒 10:00am-7:30pm (confirm exact days, especially Sundays)

Website

Map

I

Italy Overview (cruise ports & drive route)

ITALY — TRIP MAP



Schematic map (approximate positions, not to scale / not live map tiles) — for trip planning reference only

Schematic map – approximate positions, not to scale

The Republic Hotel

Hotel

Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome

Map

Civitavecchia (cruise embark / car hire)

Port / Car hire

Via 16 Settembre 46, Civitavecchia

Map

Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Hotel

Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa

Map I

Marseille, France

Cruise port of call

Marseille, France

Map I

Villefranche-sur-Mer, France

Cruise port of call

Villefranche-sur-Mer, France

Map I

Genoa, Italy

Cruise port of call

Genoa, Italy

Map I

La Spezia, Italy

Cruise port of call

La Spezia, Italy

Map

I

Il Caffè degli Amici

Cafe/restaurant - potential place to go (Tripadvisor 4.7/5, 562 reviews)

Via Roma 121, 50028 Tavarnelle Val di Pesa

Menu

Map

I

Pasticceria La Golosa

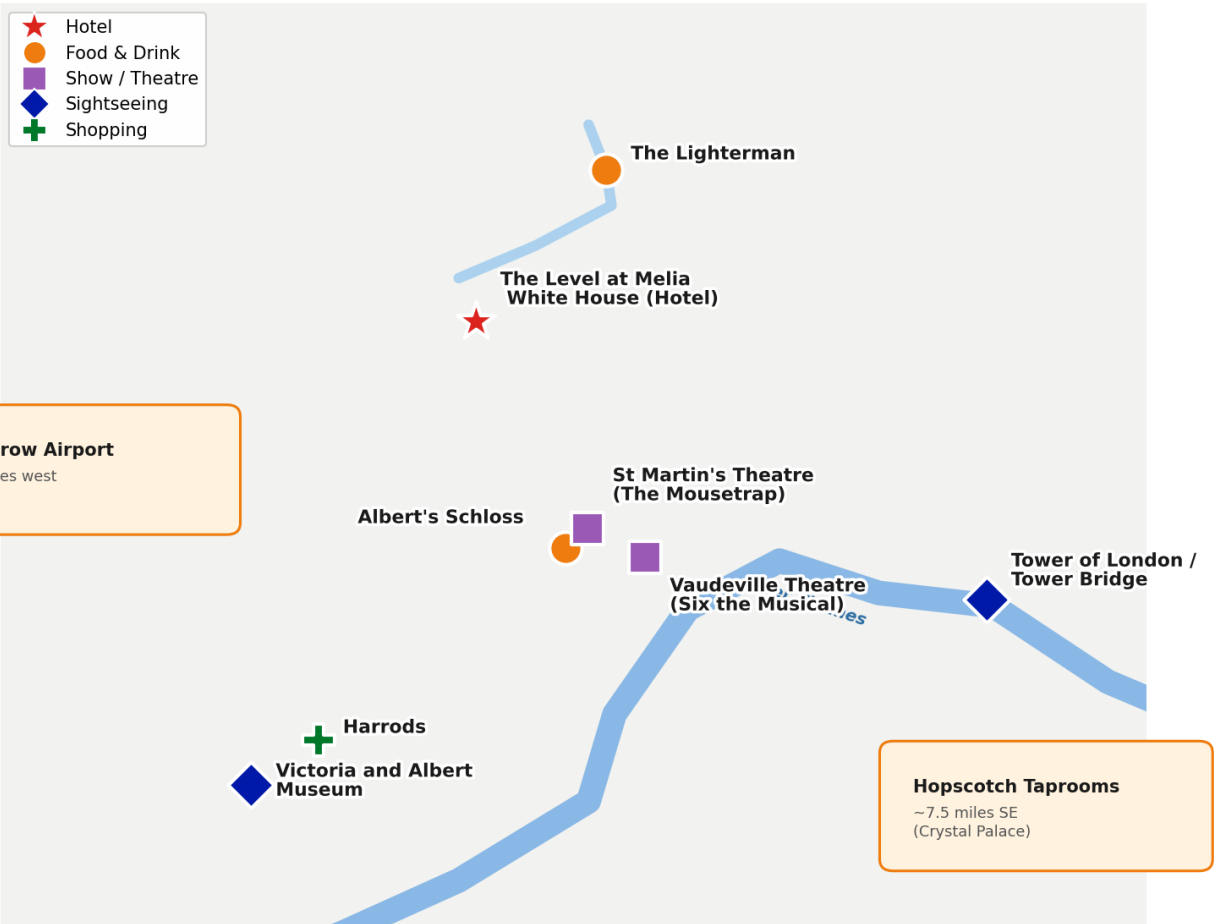
Pastry shop/cafe - potential place to go (Tripadvisor 4.4/5, 31 reviews)

Via Palazzuolo, 50028 Tavarnelle Val di Pesa

Map

LONDON — TRIP MAP

Central London



Schematic diagram (not to scale, in the style of a transit map) - use the Google Maps links in the sheet for turn-by-turn directions.

Schematic map - approximate positions, not to scale

The Level at Melia White House

Hotel - approx. 2-3 min walk (~0.2 km) to Great Portland Street Underground station (Circle, Hammersmith & City, Metropolitan lines), directly opposite the hotel

Longford Street, Regents Park, London NW1 3UP

Website

Map

I

Heathrow Airport

Travel / Airport

Heathrow Airport, Hounslow TW6 1EW

☎ 0344 335 1801

[Map](#)[I](#)

Albert's Schloss

Food & Drink

20-24 Shaftesbury Avenue, London W1D 7EU

☎ 020 8165 0000

✉ eventslondon@albertsschloss.co.uk

[Menu](#)[Map](#)[Reviews](#)[I](#)

The Lighterman

Food & Drink

3 Granary Square, London N1C 4BH

☎ 020 3846 3400

[Menu](#)[Map](#)[Reviews](#)[I](#)

St Martin's Theatre (The Mousetrap)

Show / Theatre

West Street, London WC2H 9NZ

☎ 020 7836 1443

[Map](#)

Vaudeville Theatre (Six the Musical)

Show / Theatre

404 Strand, London WC2R 0NH

☎ 0330 333 4814

✉ boxoffice@nimaxtheatres.com

[Map](#)[I](#)

Tower of London / Tower Bridge

Sightseeing

Tower of London, EC3N 4AB

☎ 020 3166 6646

[Map](#)[Reviews](#)[I](#)

Hopscotch Taprooms

Food & Drink

54 Westow Hill, London SE19 1RX

☎ +44 7394 072189

Website

Menu

Map

I

Harrods

Shopping

87-135 Brompton Road, Knightsbridge, London SW1X 7XL

☎ +44 (0)20 7730 1234

Map

I

Victoria and Albert Museum

Sightseeing

Cromwell Road, London SW7 2RL

☎ 020 7942 2000

Map

I

Harry's Knightsbridge

Food & Drink

27-31 Basil Street, Knightsbridge, London SW3 1BB

☎ +44 20 3940 1020

Website

Menu

Map

Reviews

Primark (Oxford Street)

Shopping

14-28 Oxford Street, Fitzrovia, London W1D 1AU

☎ 020 7580 5510

Map

I

Uniqlo (Oxford Street)

Shopping

311 Oxford Street, London W1C 2HP

Map

I

Waterstones Piccadilly (for Karen)

Shopping - Books

203-206 Piccadilly, London W1J 9HD

☎ 020 7851 2400

Map

I

Oxford Street

Shopping street

Oxford Street, London W1

Website

Map

I

ZTL / Limited Traffic Zones (Italy)

You asked about "LTZ" areas – in Italy these are officially called ZTL (Zona a Traffico Limitato), or Limited Traffic Zones. Every historic Italian city centre has one, and they're the single easiest way to rack up fines while self-driving.

A ZTL is a camera-enforced zone – usually the old walled/historic centre – where only residents, permit holders and registered vehicles may drive during posted hours. Drive through the wrong gate and a camera reads the plate; the fine (typically €80–335, sometimes one per gate crossed) goes to the hire company, who forwards it to us plus their own admin fee – and it can turn up months after we're home. Watch for the sign: a white circle with a red border reading "Zona Traffico Limitato".

ITALY — ZTL / LIMITED TRAFFIC ZONES



- Major city with ZTL / congestion zone (Milan, Rome)
- Town with a ZTL zone (Como, Venice, Bologna, Modena, Florence, Siena)
- Smaller ZTL / no-cars-at-all zone (Maranello, San Gimignano)
- ▲ Our Tuscany hotel, Tavarnelle Val di Pesa (for reference)

Schematic map - approximate positions, not to scale - see city notes below for hours and relevance to our route

Schematic map - approximate positions, not to scale

Rome (Centro Storico)

□ Italy's most famous ZTL - not on our drive route

Daytime hours Mon-Fri, with extended evening ZTL in some nightlife sectors on weekends - camera-enforced across the historic centre.

□ We don't collect the hire car until Civitavecchia, so this one's FYI only - but it's the zone every guide warns about first, and worth knowing about generally.

Milan - Area C

□ Congestion charge + ZTL ring around the Duomo

Mon-Fri 7:30am-7:30pm, about €7.50/entry (higher on weekends), camera-enforced seven days a week from 2026.

□ *The iQ Hotel Milano (Via Pirelli) sits just outside the Area C ring, so arriving/leaving the hotel should be fine – it only becomes a problem if we drive in towards the Duomo.*

Como & Cernobbio (Option A)

□ **Como old town ZTL - enforced daily, 9am-10pm**

Covers the walled Città Murata, Piazza Duomo and Via Vittorio Emanuele II. The Cernobbio/Tremezzo lakeside road (SS340) itself is open, but narrow and often busy.

□ *Best to park in a signed lot outside the old town (e.g. Autosilo Valduce) rather than drive in for Harry's Bar/the lakefront.*

Bologna (Option B breakfast stop)

□ **ZTL Centro Storico - every day, 7am-8pm**

Camera-enforced ("Sirio" system) across the historic centre; a few streets are pedestrian-only around the clock.

□ *Our Option B breakfast stop, Aroma Specialty Coffee on Via Portanova, sits inside this zone – better to park just outside and walk the last few minutes than drive to the door.*

Modena & Maranello (Option B)

□ **Modena's old town ZTL is effectively permit-holders-only**

Modena's historic centre is restricted for most of the day; Maranello itself has no formal ZTL, but very heavy paid parking near the Ferrari Museum.

□ *Best to follow the signed ring road/tangenziale around Modena rather than cut through its centre on the way to Maranello.*

Florence

□ **ZTL - 5 sectors, Mon-Fri 7:30am-8pm, Sat 7:30am-4pm**

Free to drive Sundays and public holidays. Covers Piazza del Duomo, Piazza della Signoria and most of the historic core.

□ *Not on our base route, but easy to stumble into if we detour into central Florence for a look.*

Siena

□ **Historic centre is effectively car-free**

The whole medieval core sits inside a strict ZTL – park in one of the signed "parcheggio scambiatore" lots outside the walls and walk in.

□ *Relevant if we make the short detour south from our hotel to see the Palio square (Piazza del Campo).*

San Gimignano

□ **No visitor cars inside the walls, ever (Apr-Oct)**

Five paid car parks (P1-P5) sit just outside the medieval gates – it's a walk up from there, whichever one we use.

□ *The 'medieval Manhattan' towers from our Day 12 Fun Facts – a natural detour from our Tuscany hotel, so worth knowing before we drive up.*

Venice (Option C)

□ **No cars at all in the historic centre - more a total ban than a ZTL**

The car has to be left on the mainland at Tronchetto or Piazzale Roma car parks; the centre itself is reached on foot or by vaporetto (water bus).

□ *Already flagged on our Option C route notes – the most extreme version of a 'limited traffic zone' in Italy.*

General rule of thumb: park in a signed paid car park outside the old walls/centre and walk in, rather than following the satnav to the door – it's almost always faster than dealing with a fine later.

Things to Do

Everything still to book or confirm, pulled together from across the itinerary.

Date	Item	Status	Notes	Book
Sat 12 Sep	Book Vatican Necropolis (Scavi Tour) - Tomb of St Peter /// searched.circling.supposed	TO BOOK	Guided tour beneath St Peter's Basilica ending at the tomb believed to hold St Peter's remains - must be booked well in advance (small groups, no photos allowed). Slotted into Saturday afternoon (after the Pristine Sistine tour and lunch) as one of the free-afternoon options. Book ahead - popular, limited daily slots.	
Mon 14 Sep	Confirm transfer time to Queen Victoria	TO CONFIRM	Transfer by private minibus, Rome to Civitavecchia - likely mid-afternoon, evening departure. Gary checked with Lynaire on 30 July, awaiting a response.	
Sat 26 Sep	Confirm Tower of London + Crown Jewels + River Tour (combo)	TO CONFIRM	To be confirmed by Jennifer from Headout (jennifer@inspire.headout.com)	
Sun 27 Sep	Confirm transfer to airport	TO CONFIRM	Leaving hotel 7:00pm for 10:00pm LHR departure	
Fri 11 Sep	Confirm booking reference for Fiumicino to hotel transfer	TO CONFIRM	Private minibus, Fiumicino Airport to The Republic Hotel (Via Gaeta 61, Rome) - arranged in principle but no booking or confirmation reference is on file	

Things to Take

Packing checklist. Tick boxes save in this browser only — they don't sync back to the spreadsheet, so keep the master list on the Things to Do tab in the workbook up to date separately.

Item	Packed?
Euro Power Adapter	☐
Passports with 6 months left	☐
Check on VPN support	☐
Hats for us all (for tours)	☐
Water (for tours)	☐
DJI Gimbal (Gary)	☐
Get some Pounds and some Euro's for OOPE	☐

☐ UK ETA Applications - tick off once each person has applied

Apply here: gov.uk/eta/apply - each of the 4 of us needs our own UK ETA before flying to London. Tick boxes save in this browser only.

Name	Applied?
Karen Nicholson	☐
Deb Gyde	☐
Thomas Akhurst	☐
Gary Nicholson	☐

☐ Passport Validity Check - tick off once each passport is confirmed valid

Passports need at least 6 months' validity remaining AT THE END of the trip (29 Sept 2026) - so valid until at least 29 March 2027. Tick boxes save in this browser only.

Name	Checked?
Karen Nicholson	☐
Deb Gyde	☐
Thomas Akhurst	☐
Gary Nicholson	☐

Hotel Addresses

Every hotel on the trip, with address, phone and email – use Print for a paper copy or a browser "Save as PDF", or Email to send yourself/family a copy.

The Republic Hotel

Via Gaeta 61, 00185 Rome, Italy

☐ **11-14 Sept 2026 (check-out morning of the 14th for Civitavecchia/cruise embarkation)**

☐ **+39 06 8115 7001**

✉ **therepublic@aghotels.it**

☐ **Booking ref - Gary & Karen: 5179180 · Deb & Tom: 5179179**

€ **Mandatory fee:** City tourist tax – €7.50 per person, per night (up to 10 nights), payable directly to the hotel



Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Via Roma 191, 50028 Tavarnelle Val di Pesa (FI), Italy

☐ **21-23 Sept 2026 (check-out morning of the 23rd for the drive to Milan)**

☐ **+39 055 807 3333**

✉ **info@borgodicortefreda.com**

☐ **Booking ref - Gary & Karen: 900422765 (hotel conf. 45873846) · Deb & Tom: 900422785 (hotel conf. 45873847)**

€ **Mandatory fee:** City tourist tax – €3.00 per person, per night (up to 7 nights), payable directly to the hotel



iQ Hotel Milano

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy

☐ **23-24 Sept 2026 (check-out morning of the 24th for the flight to London)**

☐ **+39 02 8498 0810**

✉ **info@iqhotelmilano.it**

☐ **Booking ref - Gary & Karen: 9079750869671 (conf. 2385198897) · Deb & Tom: 9074737872483 (conf. 2385198904)**

€ **Mandatory fee:** City tourist tax – €10.00 per person, per night, payable directly to the hotel



The Level at Melia White House

Longford Street, Regent's Park, London NW1 3UP, United Kingdom

☐ **24-27 Sept 2026 (depart Heathrow the night of the 27th)**

☐ **+44 20 7391 3000**

✉ **melia.white.house@melia.com**

☐ **Great Portland Street station (Circle, Hammersmith & City, Metropolitan lines) - approx. 2-3 min walk (~0.2 km), directly opposite the hotel**

☐ **Booking ref - Gary & Karen: 702Lb92xxk · Deb & Tom: 702Hpxuze6**



Daily Quiz

A 5-question multi-choice quiz for every day of the trip, themed to wherever we are that day – Rome history, cruise trivia, French Riviera, Tuscany, London and more. Browse the questions below any time, or print two separate documents: one with just the questions, one with the answer key.

Questions

Day 2 · Fri 11 Sep · Rome Arrival

1. Which river runs through the middle of Rome?

A) The Po B) The Tiber C) The Arno D) The Danube

2. Rome is famously said to be built on how many hills?

A) Five B) Six C) Seven D) Nine

3. What is the name of the independent city-state entirely enclosed within Rome?

A) San Marino B) Monaco C) Vatican City D) Andorra

4. Which ancient structure is also known by its Latin name, the Amphitheatrum Flavium?

A) The Pantheon B) The Colosseum C) The Circus Maximus D) The Roman Forum

5. Legend says Rome was founded by twin brothers raised by a wolf. What were their names?

A) Castor and Pollux B) Romulus and Remus C) Brutus and Cassius D) Titus and Vespasian

Day 3 · Sat 12 Sep · Vatican & Sistine Chapel

1. Who painted the ceiling of the Sistine Chapel?

A) Leonardo da Vinci B) Raphael C) Michelangelo D) Botticelli

2. Roughly how long did it take Michelangelo to paint the Sistine Chapel ceiling?

A) About 1 year B) About 4 years C) About 10 years D) About 20 years

3. What is the name of Michelangelo's huge fresco on the Sistine Chapel's altar wall, painted decades after the ceiling?

A) The Creation of Adam B) The Last Supper C) The Last Judgment D) The School of Athens

4. What is the world's smallest country by area, which we're visiting today?

A) Monaco B) Vatican City C) San Marino D) Liechtenstein

5. What is the name of the huge square in front of St Peter's Basilica, ringed by Bernini's colonnades?

A) Piazza Navona B) Piazza del Popolo C) St Peter's Square D) Piazza di Spagna

Day 4 · Sun 13 Sep · Colosseum

1. In roughly what year did construction of the Colosseum finish?

A) 80 AD B) 200 AD C) 30 BC D) 500 AD

2. Roughly how many spectators could the Colosseum hold?

A) 5,000 B) 15,000 C) 50,000-80,000 D) 200,000

3. What was the underground network of tunnels and animal cages beneath the arena floor called?

A) The Catacombs B) The Hypogeum C) The Forum D) The Atrium

4. Which Roman emperor commissioned the Colosseum?

A) Nero B) Augustus C) Vespasian D) Julius Caesar

5. What stone makes up most of the Colosseum's outer structure?

A) Marble B) Travertine limestone C) Granite D) Brick only

Day 5 · Mon 14 Sep · Rome to the Cruise

1. What is the name of the ship we're boarding today?

A) Queen Mary 2 B) Queen Elizabeth C) Queen Victoria D) Queen Anne

2. Which shipping line operates Queen Victoria?

A) Cunard B) P&O C) Princess Cruises D) Royal Caribbean

3. Which Cunard liner sank after being torpedoed in 1915, helping draw the US into WWI?

A) Titanic B) Lusitania C) Britannic D) Mauretania

4. What year was the Cunard Line founded?

A) 1740 B) 1840 C) 1900 D) 1950

5. Which Italian port are we sailing from today?

A) Naples B) Genoa C) Civitavecchia D) Livorno

Day 6 · Tue 15 Sep · Sea Day

1. The Mediterranean Sea connects to the Atlantic Ocean via which strait?

A) Strait of Messina B) Strait of Gibraltar C) The Bosphorus D) Strait of Otranto

2. Which is the largest island in the Mediterranean?

A) Corsica B) Cyprus C) Sicily D) Sardinia

3. Approximately how deep is the Mediterranean's deepest point, the Calypso Deep?

A) About 500m B) About 2,000m C) About 5,200m D) About 10,000m

4. Which sea connects to the Mediterranean via the Dardanelles and Bosphorus straits?

A) The Red Sea B) The Black Sea C) The Caspian Sea D) The Adriatic Sea

5. What unit is traditionally used to measure a ship's speed at sea?

A) Miles per hour B) Knots C) Fathoms per hour D) Leagues per hour

Day 7 · Wed 16 Sep · Marseille, France

1. Marseille is France's ___ largest city.

A) Largest B) Second-largest C) Third-largest D) Fifth-largest

2. Marseille was founded by settlers from which ancient civilisation, around 600 BC?

A) Romans B) Phoenicians C) Greeks (Phocaeans) D) Etruscans

3. What is France's national anthem called, named after soldiers from Marseille who sang it marching to Paris in 1792?

A) La Vie en Rose B) La Marseillaise C) Non, Je Ne Regrette Rien D) Frère Jacques

4. What is the traditional Provençal fish stew Marseille is famous for?

A) Ratatouille B) Bouillabaisse C) Cassoulet D) Coq au vin

5. What is the fortified hilltop basilica overlooking Marseille's harbour called?

A) Notre-Dame de la Garde B) Sacré-Cœur C) Notre-Dame de Paris D) Sainte-Chapelle

Day 8 · Thu 17 Sep · Villefranche & Monaco

1. Monaco is the second-smallest country in the world. Which is the smallest?

A) San Marino B) Vatican City C) Liechtenstein D) Malta

2. Which royal family has ruled Monaco for over 700 years?

A) The Windsors B) The Grimaldis C) The Bourbons D) The Habsburgs

3. What famous annual motor race runs through the streets of Monaco?

A) Le Mans 24 Hours B) Monaco Grand Prix C) Dakar Rally D) Tour de France

4. Which Hollywood actress became Princess of Monaco in 1956, marrying Prince Rainier III?

A) Audrey Hepburn B) Grace Kelly C) Ingrid Bergman D) Elizabeth Taylor

5. Monaco residents famously pay no what?

A) Council rates B) Income tax C) Road tolls D) Import duty

Day 9 · Fri 18 Sep · Genoa, Italy

- 1. Which explorer, credited with reaching the Americas in 1492, was born in Genoa?**
A) Marco Polo B) Amerigo Vespucci C) Christopher Columbus D) Ferdinand Magellan
- 2. Genoa is the capital of which Italian region?**
A) Tuscany B) Liguria C) Piedmont D) Lombardy
- 3. Which world-famous basil sauce originated in Genoa?**
A) Marinara B) Pesto C) Alfredo D) Arrabbiata
- 4. Genoa's historic centre is often ranked among Europe's largest what?**
A) Medieval castles B) Medieval old towns C) Cathedrals D) Palace complexes
- 5. In the Middle Ages, Genoa was a powerful maritime republic rivalling which other Italian sea power?**
A) Naples B) Venice C) Palermo D) Bari

Day 10 · Sat 19 Sep · La Spezia & Pisa

- 1. The Leaning Tower of Pisa started leaning almost immediately, mainly because of what?**
A) An earthquake B) Soft, unstable ground C) A design flaw in the bells D) War damage
- 2. How many storeys does the Leaning Tower of Pisa have?**
A) 4 B) 6 C) 8 D) 12
- 3. What type of building is the Leaning Tower actually part of?**
A) A city hall B) A cathedral bell tower (campanile) C) A fortress D) A university
- 4. Which scientist, born in Pisa, is said (probably as legend) to have dropped balls from the tower to study gravity?**
A) Leonardo da Vinci B) Galileo Galilei C) Copernicus D) Archimedes
- 5. La Spezia sits at the gateway to which colourful stretch of Ligurian coastline, famous for five cliffside villages?**
A) Amalfi Coast B) Cinque Terre C) Costa Smeralda D) Riviera di Levante

Day 11 · Sun 20 Sep · Sea Day

1. **Which is traditionally considered the longest river in the world?**

A) Amazon B) Nile C) Yangtze D) Mississippi

2. **Which is the largest ocean on Earth?**

A) Atlantic B) Indian C) Arctic D) Pacific

3. **Which country has the most time zones?**

A) Russia B) USA C) France D) China

4. **What is the smallest continent by land area?**

A) Europe B) Australia/Oceania C) Antarctica D) South America

5. **Which mountain range forms part of the traditional boundary between Europe and Asia?**

A) The Alps B) The Urals C) The Pyrenees D) The Carpathians

Day 12 · Mon 21 Sep · Tuscany (Talamone & Chianti)

1. **What colour is the rooster on the seal of authentic Chianti Classico wine?**

A) Red B) White C) Black D) Gold

2. **Which grape variety is Chianti primarily made from?**

A) Nebbiolo B) Sangiovese C) Barbera D) Montepulciano

3. **In Dante's Divine Comedy, which section mockingly mentions Talamone, the port we're passing through today?**

A) Inferno B) Purgatorio C) Paradiso D) It isn't mentioned

4. **Tuscany's capital and the birthplace of the Renaissance is which city?**

A) Siena B) Pisa C) Florence D) Lucca

5. **What is the name for the low stone farmhouse-style accommodation common across the Tuscan countryside?**

A) Villa B) Agriturismo C) Palazzo D) Trattoria

Day 13 · Tue 22 Sep · Tuscany Free Day

1. **San Gimignano, near our hotel, is famous for its skyline of medieval what?**
A) Windmills B) Towers C) Bridges D) Domes
2. **How many of San Gimignano's original ~72 medieval towers still survive today?**
A) About 3 B) About 14 C) About 40 D) All 72
3. **Which Renaissance polymath was born in a small Tuscan town near Florence, sharing his name with it?**
A) Michelangelo Buonarroti B) Leonardo da Vinci C) Sandro Botticelli D) Donatello
4. **The Chianti wine region lies roughly between which two famous Tuscan cities?**
A) Florence and Siena B) Pisa and Lucca C) Florence and Rome D) Siena and Rome
5. **Which powerful banking family ruled Florence and patronised the Renaissance for generations?**
A) The Borgias B) The Medici C) The Sforza D) The Visconti

Day 14 · Wed 23 Sep · Milan (Options Day)

1. **Roughly how long did Milan's Duomo take to complete, from start to its final touches?**
A) About 10 years B) About 50 years C) Nearly 6 centuries D) 100 years
2. **Leonardo da Vinci's mural The Last Supper is housed in which Milan building?**
A) Milan Cathedral B) Santa Maria delle Grazie C) La Scala D) Castello Sforzesco
3. **Milan is considered, alongside Paris, one of the world capitals of which industry?**
A) Finance B) Fashion C) Film D) Publishing
4. **What is the name of Milan's world-famous opera house?**
A) La Fenice B) La Scala C) San Carlo D) Teatro Massimo
5. **If we take the Como option today, whose famous villa on Lake Como's shore might we spot?**
A) Elton John's B) George Clooney's C) Tom Cruise's D) Ed Sheeran's

Day 15 · Thu 24 Sep · London Arrival

- 1. What is the name of the river that flows through London?**
A) The Severn B) The Thames C) The Avon D) The Mersey
- 2. Approximately how long is the River Thames?**
A) 50 miles B) 100 miles C) 215 miles D) 400 miles
- 3. What is London's famous clock tower usually called, after the bell inside it?**
A) Big Ben B) The Shard C) The Gherkin D) The Elizabeth Tower
- 4. Which London Underground line is coloured dark blue on the Tube map?**
A) Circle line B) Piccadilly line C) Victoria line D) Central line
- 5. What is the collective name for London's famous red double-decker vehicles?**
A) Trams B) Buses C) Tuk-tuks D) Trolleys

Day 16 · Fri 25 Sep · London (The Mousetrap)

- 1. The Mousetrap, which we're seeing tonight, is the world's longest-running what?**
A) Musical B) Play C) Opera D) Ballet
- 2. Who wrote The Mousetrap?**
A) Agatha Christie B) Arthur Conan Doyle C) Noël Coward D) J.B. Priestley
- 3. Which London theatre district is home to most of the famous long-running shows?**
A) Shoreditch B) West End C) Camden D) South Bank
- 4. The Mousetrap first opened in the West End in which decade?**
A) 1930s B) 1950s C) 1970s D) 1990s
- 5. Traditionally, audiences leaving The Mousetrap are asked to do what?**
A) Sign a guestbook B) Keep the ending a secret C) Take a photo with the cast D) Write a review

Day 17 · Sat 26 Sep · London (Tower Bridge & Six)

- 1. How many wives did King Henry VIII have - the subject of tonight's show, Six?**
A) Four B) Five C) Six D) Seven
- 2. Which of his six wives was famously beheaded, and was the second wife?**
A) Catherine of Aragon B) Anne Boleyn C) Jane Seymour D) Catherine Howard
- 3. Tower Bridge, which we visit today, is often confused with which other London bridge?**
A) Millennium Bridge B) London Bridge C) Westminster Bridge D) Blackfriars Bridge
- 4. What famous fortress sits beside Tower Bridge, once used as a royal palace and prison?**
A) Windsor Castle B) The Tower of London C) Buckingham Palace D) Hampton Court
- 5. What valuable items are famously kept and guarded at the Tower of London?**
A) The Crown Jewels B) The original Magna Carta C) The Domesday Book D) Nelson's flagship

Answer Key

Hidden from normal browsing so the quiz stays a surprise – use Print Answers to check your scores.

London Tube Map

The official TfL Tube map, saved here so it's always at hand even offline.

 [CLICK HERE to view the Tube Map \(PDF\)](#)

Emergency Contacts

Emergency contacts back home for each couple, in case anyone needs to reach family while we're away.

Karen & Gary Nicholson

Emma Warmouth

☎ +64 27 848 6867

✉ emma.warmouth@nzdata.co.nz

David Nicholson

☎ +64 27 856 7966

✉ davidnicholson@hotmail.com

Steve Nicholson

☎ +64 27 873 9578

✉

Martina Gyde

☎ +64 27 590 4156

✉ martinag@xtra.co.nz

Gary Nicholson

☎ +64 27 542 7747

✉ gary.nicholson@garrison.co.nz

☎ International Drivers Licence: IDP196978

☎ ETA reference number: 2020-0000-6027-5337

Karen Nicholson

☎ +64 275 536 746

✉ karen.nicholson@garrison.co.nz

☎ ETA reference number: 2020-0000-6027-5878

Deb Gyde & Thomas Akhurst

Person 1 - (add name)

✉

Person 2 - (add name)

✉

Person 3 - (add name)

✉

Person 4 - (add name)

✉

Travel Documents

Key trip documents, saved here so they're always at hand – open on screen or scan the QR code with your phone.

Travel Docs



Car Docs



ETA Confirmation (Gary)



G&K Travel Insurance



Six the Musical Booking



QV Deck Plans



International Driving Permit (IDP) Check

Whoever's driving in Italy needs a valid IDP alongside their normal licence. Tick boxes save in this browser only.

Name	Have IDP?	IDP Number
Karen Nicholson	☐	
Deb Gyde	☐	
Thomas Akhurst	☐	

